

## MAKASING AND THE WORLD BEYOND

This Chapter details the places and people of Coyote & Crow. It describes the cities, nations, and continents and the cultures, technologies and notable places within each. To start, we're going to focus on the city of Cahokia. Then we will zoom out and talk about the Free Lands, the other nations on the continent of Makasing, and briefly look into the nations in the areas known as Abayang and Azayang.

### Cahokia: An Introduction

#### Why Cahokia?

The world that you are entering is a big one. Trying to detail even five nations in this book would be a monumental task. That is just Makasing, not to mention the other seven nations. Just covering all the Free Lands is still an enormous task. Instead, we suggest you start your game in the city of Cahokia. Focusing on a single

metropolitan city will give you a chance to steep yourself in this world while also giving us the space to tell you about this amazing place in greater detail. Below is a description of daily life in Cahokia and what the city feels like. Additional details about telling stories in the city will be detailed in the chapter Forging Your Saga.

#### The Basics

Cahokia is the largest city in Makasing. It is home to over two million people and is widely considered the most diverse and culturally expansive city in the world. As a sovereign city-state, it bows to no one and has powerful treaties and alliances with every other nation in the world. It does not rule over the Free Lands, but it leads the other cities and municipalities through strong relationships and a shared understanding.

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The other city-states and governments within the Free Lands are autonomous and bound loosely through alliances with their immediate neighbors and Cahokia. Cahokia itself sits on more than 500 square miles of land along the Mizizibi river, roughly where the real-world city of St. Louis exists, and extends south.

The city has a long and fascinating history. Structures date back more than a 1000 years. The city was mostly abandoned prior to the Awis, but was revitalized years later as trade became more essential than ever. Eventually, the city became the birthplace of modern exchange, the root of a common trade language called Chahi, the most spoken language on the continent, and the originator of the most recognized currency in use, nizi.

Cahokia is a sprawling, energetic city, but not a hurried or crowded one. Between the large underground tunnel system, plenty of available land, and the warming weather, there is space for everyone. During the day, people work, play, learn, and farm. At night, there's a growing entertainment and leisure scene as people begin to truly reap the rewards of their hard work and advances.

Without the poverty and inequality present in our real world cities, there is not as much petty crime. But that doesn't mean that Cahokia is a safe place or that there aren't dangers. Clashing belief systems, political and spiritual, are always simmering below the surface. There are secrets around every corner and new threats lurking in every shadow.





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# KEY

- Subterranean Rail - Soko Uraku
- Subterranean Rail Stations
- Mound
- Built Structures





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## Annotations

1. **Papanshin** - agricultural area on the western shore of the Mizizibi
2. **Gichi-Michim** - a floating market in an artificial bay east of Chizi specializing in foods
3. **Chizi** - northernmost district of Cahokia, physically separated from the rest of the city by the Mizizibi and Minishoshi rivers
4. **Chizi Market** - a market in the Chizi district specializing in exotic tech and goods from outside Makasing, as well as gats of every description
5. **Chizi boat yards**
6. **Chizi housing area** - primarily occupied by boatwrights and traders
7. **Chizi community gardens**
8. **Chizi Port**
9. **Nabanamo District**
10. **Yosna Nizig Hotel**
11. **Niwaanaki** - fine dining restaurant
12. **Mnondamwin** - home cooking restaurant
13. **Wooncha** - comedy club with less than trustworthy dining
14. **Nookaroobi** - night club
15. **Olowag Yipihachankana** - retro night club aimed at elders
16. **Yitiisi Gami Lake**
17. **Wiijiwanka District**
18. **Natsoo Wanka Hapaki** - Cahokia's largest teaching hospital
19. **Natsoo Wanka Hapaki Medicinal Garden** - where botanists, healers, and their students work together growing and gathering plants for nutritional and medicinal purposes in addition to developing new varieties with increased efficacy
20. **Pikisi Wanka Market** - specializing in clothes, beautification, personal adornment
21. **Nasokootoo** - public sauna
22. **Nigikitho** - tattoo shop
23. **Housing developments** - for doctors, comedians, poets, deathworkers, beauticians
24. **Nahikoongi residential district**
25. **Housing developments** - for farmers, builders, makers, tech scientists, and city workers responsible for the health of the city, each with their own community gardens
26. **Nahikoongi Market** - the place for handmade goods and Cahokia-specific items at good prices
27. **Akalaw** - Tokwet's carefully tended botanical garden



28. **Mataawi District**
29. **Mataawi Building** - The meeting place of the Council of Twelve and central government building
30. **Nigichazii** - census building
31. **Baya Wanka** - public aid office
32. **Hanayan** - post office
33. **Nithiicha**- public works
34. **Anpa Gatchoo** - eastern Gatchoo stadium
35. **Wiya Gatchoo** - western Gatchoo stadium
36. **Nawit** - handgame arena
37. **Housing areas for bureaucrats, clerks**, mid-level comedians and poets, athletes, and sports related professions with fairly sparse community gardens
38. **Michim ga Wayoopiki Market** - mostly food and tech, close to government offices
39. **Hapaki Mininan District** - the five island district where all Cahokia's children are educated through university level
40. **Chikan Thunwi Plaza** - the newly rebuilt plaza, original to the ancient city, one of Cahokia's proudest new public works

## Cahokia

The metropolis built by the mound-builders was not known as Cahokia to its real world inhabitants. The word Cahokia comes from an Algonquian-speaking nation in the Inoka Confederation, which inhabited the area around Cahokia in the 1600s. The Inoka are more broadly known as the Illinois, an English understanding of a French take on an Anishinaabe word — a common pattern throughout Indigenous history.

So if Cahokia wasn't called Cahokia (or Inoka, or Illinois), what was it called originally? Unfortunately, as of this writing, we don't know. What we do know is that the English word Cahokia has tremendous resonance within the Indigenous community. It is representative of an economic, spiritual, and political center that was thriving long before any inhabitant of Turtle Island had met the Europeans who would eventually colonize the continent. The word might not fit our world — but the sentiment it evokes does.



## Further Cahokia Descriptions:

Modern Cahokia is a city that has grown long and narrow over the years on the eastern shore of the Mizizibi River, with the western shore given over to agriculture.

This western agricultural district is criss-crossed by a network of canals, used for agricultural transport, irrigation, and flood control. Cahokia itself radiates from two centers of activity; one in the north where the Mizizibi River and Minishoshi Rivers meet and to the south, the Old City of Cahokia.

The northern hub rests on a tongue of land between the Mizizibi and Minishoshi Rivers, giving the district its name of Chizi, or tongue. This northernmost district of the city of Cahokia is easily the most populous and energetic. A natural site for riverboat building and repair, as well as trade, the northern end of Chizi is the home of many traders and boatwrights, as well as the site of Cahokia's thriving river port. However the biggest draw to Chizi is its massive tech market, a large portion of which revolves around the buying, selling, and repair of gats. If you want tech, Chizi is the place to find it.

Across the Mizizibi is a large man-made bay Gichi-Michim, which serves as a floating food market. Gichi-Michim boasts foods from not only all of Makasing but even the far reaches of the Ezcan Empire.

Immediately beside the shores of Gichi-Michim is the thriving Nabanamo district. Nabanamo serves both traders, visitors, and citizens alike, buzzing with activity in a throng of hotels, restaurants, theatres, and nightclubs. Two popular restaurants are Niwaanki for up-scale dining and Minondamwin for a more down-home fare. Nabanamo's offerings run the gamut from haute cuisine to simple stalls with no seating. Comedy clubs like Wooncha provide cheap eats and entertainment as well as a venue for up-and-coming comedians and poets hoping to work in either a major arena or one of Cahokia's hospitals; in other words, the Big Time. Night clubs offer an array of musical genres. Theatres ranging from groundbreaking avant garde productions to the classics are performed in a variety of venues. Almost all of Nabanamo's residents work in the district, near or even in their workplaces.



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Natsoo Wanka Hapaki is a large teaching hospital and supplies healers to hospitals in other districts of Cahokia and is located just outside the agreed upon boundary of Nabanamo. Natsoo Wanka Hapaki is a sign you have reached the Wijiwanka district.

Located directly adjacent to Natsoo Wanka Hapaki are the Natsoo Wanka Hapaki Botanical Gardens where botanists and healers, as well their students, work together growing and gathering plants for nutritional and medicinal purposes.

Wijiwanka is mostly populated by healers and those who work with the care of the self, from tailors to beauticians to doctors to the highest level of storytellers and comedians, as well as deathworkers. Comedians in particular are important in this district, as those at the top of their art form perform in Cahokia's hospitals where they are known to be a necessary part of the healing process. The Nansyakt Market in Wijiwanka is renowned as a place to find the most beautiful clothes, personal enhancements, and relaxation services. The inhabitants of Wijiwanka are not known for being excessively humble; some other districts may even consider them to have too high an opinion of themselves.

South of Wijiwanka is the district of Nahikoongi. Nahikoongi is largely residential. The biggest groups in the district are farmers, builders, makers, scientists, and city workers responsible for the health of the city. Nahikoongi is easily the most beautiful part of the city, with lovely and productive food gardens. The Nahikoongi market is an amazing mixture of handmade art and goods local to Cahokia and while it may lack the exotic merchandise of the Chizi market, it is definitely cheaper than the markets of either Chizi or Mataawi.

The southern district centers around the Council of Twelve building, which shares its name of Mataawi with the district. It is immediately surrounded by bureaucratic offices. Among these are the census building called the Nigichazii, the public aid office or Baya Wanka, Henayan or the central post office, and the public works office or Nishiicha.

Beyond the official government buildings are an array of temples and several large stadiums. Two massive outdoor Gatchoo stadiums tower on the east and west sides of the Mataawi, the Anpa Gatchoo and the Wiya Gatchoo.



respectively, and to the south lies a specially-made indoor handgame arena, the Hapa Wanka. Chunkey, Ollama, and 12 Hole centers also draw people to the south side of the city for pleasure and gambling rather than business. Bureaucrats at all levels and those in the sports industry live in nearby housing developments, as well as some mid-level comedians and poets. Storytellers, poets, and comedians are an integral part of events in all the sporting arenas. Interestingly, a good number of farmers also live in housing areas in this district because of its proximity to nearby river crossings to the agricultural district's canals. These farmers also operate a market in Mataawi that capitalizes on its proximity to government buildings and busy arenas.

Hapiki Mininan is the name of a district made of the islands in the middle of the Mizizibi River where no one permanently lives, but where the schools for the children of Cahokia are located. The islands are naturally occurring but have been stabilized and had their size augmented by the Cahokians. Hapiki Mininan is the showplace of Cahokia, where each city district tries to outdo the others in generously supplying the best for the students of the city.

## Politics and Government

The city-state of Cahokia is run under a set of principles that are very similar to a market socialist government with elements of a gifting economy. Citizens of Cahokia generally believe that no one can truly "own" land. While most people have permanent homes and many live within the city all of their lives, everyone understands that the land they build on is not something that is theirs individually, but something they have collectively agreed to share. That doesn't mean that there are no concepts of stewardship of land or ownership in general. The best way to understand the attitude of Cahokians is that rather than having "land rights" they have "land responsibilities."

While the government has plenty of its own industry — engineering and infrastructure, medicine and science, defense and law enforcement, education, food, water, power, safety, etc. — there are also plenty of private businesses that are free to operate under the watchful eye of the Council. Overall, almost one fourth of the population works for the Council in some form or another. Another large percentage work directly in



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trade, shipping, and other associated business. The rest of the population are either children, the retired or infirm, and those working in the arts or private businesses.

The primary ruling body of Cahokia is the Council of Twelve, often abbreviated to the Council. The positions are lifetime appointments, in theory. Council members may step down, retire, or be removed, but that rarely happens in modern Cahokia. Council members propose new members and the citizens vote on an approval, but proposed members are almost never rejected. The original twelve were selected by their respective tribes as representatives of the twelve most influential in the city. However, over the years, the Council has morphed into being more about individual families retaining their positions through inheritance and nepotism. The current Council of Twelve are from among the most powerful families in the region and they all maintain a delicate balance between doing what is best for Cahokia and doing what is best for their lineage.

Cahokia has no official army, although all citizens must participate in some form of community

## "Suyata"

Suyata doesn't look like a Chahi word, because it isn't. The word itself is the Kewtowagi word for "chosen." The position itself originated in that federation, and served to help bring together a multi-ethnic society within one common rule of law. Since then, the model of selecting marshals from many small areas and giving them broad authority throughout the entire nation has spread throughout Makasing, including in Cahokia. Chahi speakers have many slang words for the Suyata, including yata — a derogatory term for a gossip, carrying the connotation of talking oneself to death.

service for two full winters, either upon adulthood or before being granted full citizenship. There are many types of law enforcement officials in Cahokia and throughout the Free Lands and other nations, but most are local, on the city level. One of the exceptions is the Suyata.



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The Suyata are something similar to marshals. These people travel throughout the Free Lands and have extensive authority. They act as officers during times of war. They often work in small groups, but can work alone. There are upwards of 10,000 Suyata serving at any one time, although the Council of Twelve keeps their exact numbers and locations a mystery for security reasons. The Suyata, or Chosen, are feared by some, respected by many, operating with impunity and above the laws that they enforce. At the same time, they are held to very high standards and go through rigorous physical, moral, and spiritual training. Their duties vary from espionage and warfare to daily order maintaining and disaster aid. They arrange and enforce treaties and act as border patrol, security for VIPs or events, and even as rangers into unknown lands. They are seen as fair, just, powerful, and skilled. Yet they are still human; there are many who resent their seemingly unchecked authority. People who aspire to be Suyata often fail the exhaustive training process and end up being local constables or other law enforcement with less stringent requirements.

## Demographics

The citizens of Cahokia claim more than 200 different tribal affiliations and people from all twelve nations call it home. The average home in the city has three generations living in it. Due to the massive leaps in technology over the last 100 years, the life expectancy and birth rate has escalated quickly and infant mortality has plummeted. While it hasn't caused a crunch yet, public officials are already warning that the coming population explosion will be a major hurdle soon.

A large majority of the population considers themselves spiritual to some degree. Even those who don't hold deep beliefs almost always observe tribal and family traditions. Roughly 75% of the population lives within five miles of the river bank that the city stretches along. The other 25% are spread out of the remaining 16 or so miles, mostly among farmland.

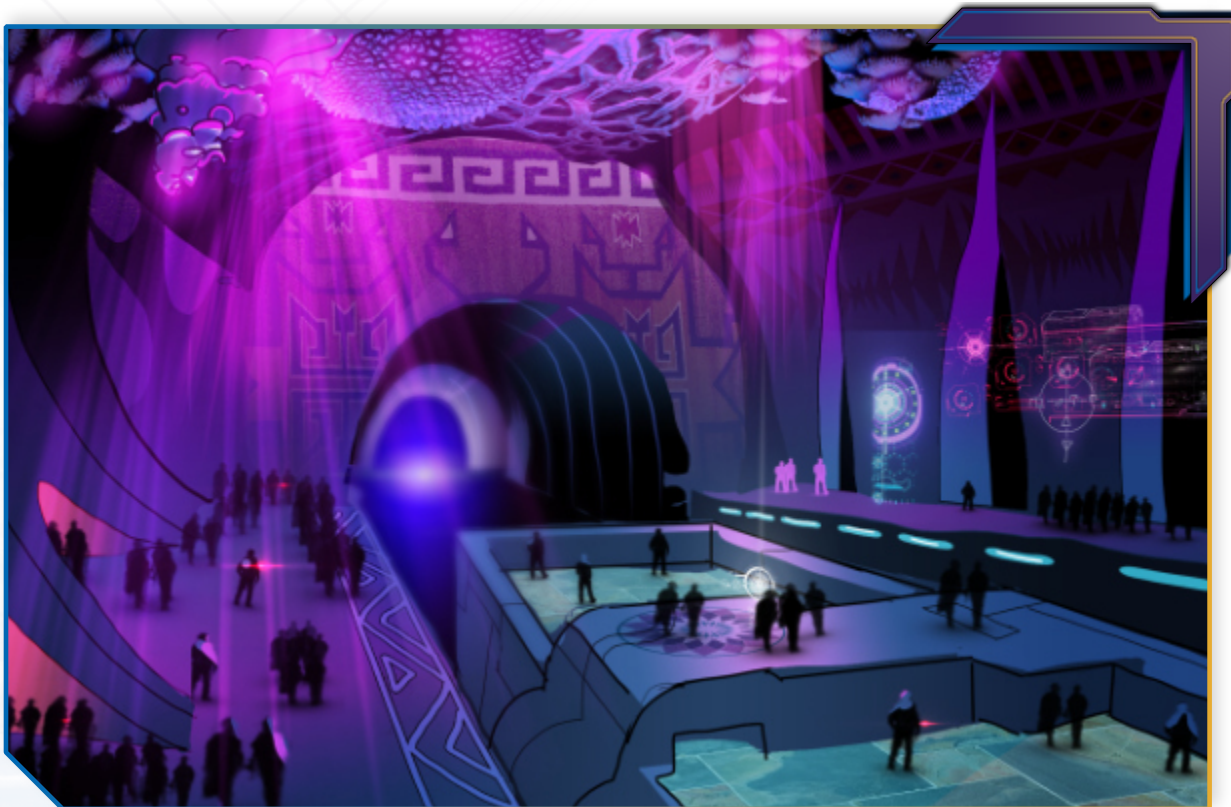
Of the two plus million inhabitants, more than 99% have gone through the Adanadi. Since the number of people who gain superhuman abilities from the Adanadi is about 20%, almost 400,000 people are Adanadi-gifted.



## Infrastructure and Architecture

While none of the original structures truly still stand, the center of Cahokian government still utilizes the largest of the ancient mounds, which is more than 100 feet tall and now supports a twenty-two foot tall structure atop the mound. Originally, the mounds were used for various ceremonial and special purposes. When Cahokia was re-invented and re-populated, the cold drove the new residents to find fresh purpose for the mound. They dug

in from the top, creating underground dwellings. Once deep enough, some of the primary structures were connected by underground tunnels, enabling people to traverse from one mound to another while avoiding the harsh outdoor winters. Modern homes in Cahokia have a majority of their livable square footage underground in mounds, while a small amount of space is left up top for a couple of rooms. These are often left unused in the colder weeks of winter.





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Power is delivered to citizens through their own highly efficient solar panels, wind turbines, and hydroelectric taps in the river. There is no city grid or overall power structure, as most homes have multiple ways to generate more than enough for their own needs.

Walkways flow between these mounds and to tunnel entrances. A dozen yutsu trains continuously move through the singular circular route around the city, providing transportation to those who have to get to the other side of town. Overhead, silent, flat bottomed yutsu barges float just above the rooftops, like giant boats in the sky, carrying cargo and passengers to far away places.

Human-made objects stand out distinctly from natural objects in color and presentation. The people of Cahokia celebrate their cultures and their tribes with vibrant paints and elaborate patterns. The structures and technology are designed to co-exist side by side with fastidious gardening and greenery within the city.

Even more than the rest of the world, Cahokia is buzzing with the latest technology. Geothermal,

wind, hydroelectric, and solar power all contribute to a clean and powerful supply of energy within Cahokia. Heat, cooling, electricity, and other power are plentiful and consistent.

Human waste is funneled to four treatment facilities outside of the city and diverted away from water sources. These waste treatment plants are tiny fabricated islands with enclosed structures. Inside these autonomous facilities are millions of beetles and grubs that consume the waste and breed inside the enclosed spaces. Surrounding these facilities is a deep narrow moat filled with fish that eat any beetles that escape.

Separately, yutsu technology is used to help pump in fresh water for drinking, irrigation, and bathing from the river and other water sources. It goes through strict filtration measures before being allowed to pass back to the place it came from.

Places to stay for short term visits, similar to a hotel or short term rental apartment, are available for travelers, but it's just as common for visitors to stay with acquaintances, colleagues, or distant relatives who often have room to



spare. With larger family units, it's not uncommon for visitors to stay with friends for extended periods. There are no people facing homelessness in Cahokia. All permanent residents are given homes to suit their needs.

No one is required to work, but almost everyone of adult age who can pay taxes does in some form or another. Operating a private business within the city limits is taxed heavily, but not so much that it drives away business. Cahokia is still at its heart, a trading city, and its market center is unmatched.

- » *Arriving at Gashigish's door, the party is greeted by a whirlwind of chestnut hair, a wide grin, and flashing green eyes flecked with gold.*
- » *"Welcome" the woman who opened the door says, "Follow me!" She leads everyone through a room with white-washed walls adorned with paintings, colorful carved gourd masks, and vibrant finger-woven tapestries; a cozy living space furnished with overstuffed chairs and so many plants they almost forget they have stepped indoors. A wide set of intri-*

*cately carved wooden doors open onto an inner courtyard paved with sandstone. The walls are lined with shelves stocked with squash of every size and shade, exquisite woven baskets brimming with root vegetables, and intriguing clay pots with contents carefully labeled but still mysterious to the untrained eye. Bundles of herbs and braided strings of chiles hang, drying in the sun, which dapples through an open roof crisscrossed with rough hewn beams, entwined with honeysuckle and wisteria. Their rustic appearance all but conceals the retractable skylight panels, which are folded upon themselves to welcome the clear, cool afternoon air.*

- » *On the eastern end of the courtyard, an earthen oven flickers beside another cooking fire built directly on the stone floor. A cooking grate sits over the fire, supporting a number of heavy-looking pots, the contents of which fill the space with aromas that are at once familiar, comforting, and beguiling. The array of simmering vessels are tended by a figure in a sweeping long skirt and apron,*



*crouched carefully, stoking the fire with a long gnarled branch.*

» *“Grandmother,” the bounding guide calls out to her, “our first visitors are here!” The figure stands and turns toward the group, revealing a warm, weathered face, framed by the same chestnut hair, the same flashing green eyes flecked with gold, but deepened with age and untold wisdom.*

» *“Oh welcome, so glad to see you!” Gashigish says, her glowing smile resting comfortably in the lines of her face, telling the story of so many years of sharing her hearth and hospitality. “Roast turkey in the oven, it’ll be just a while yet, please come in, sit...”*

» *Gashigish motions to a long cedar plank table at the center of the courtyard. The table has been set with a motley of hand-made terracotta tableware, linen-lined baskets of warm chestnut bread, jars of kaleidoscopic-hued pickled vegetables, and steaming pitchers of fragrant tea. “We’ve got a few more friends to join us tonight, please sit, sit, have some tea!” Gashigish’s voice lilts over the*

*sound of the crackling fire as she bustles around her work bench, chopping, stirring, a dance of productivity. The party settles into a well-worn arm-chair at the table and pours mugs of tea; the bouquet of curative herbs and relaxing floral notes melts everyone into their seat even before the first sip. There is an unmistakable sense of home.*

## Food and Farming

The classic food triad known as the Three Sisters is a culinary centerpiece for many in Cahokia and the surrounding Free Lands, and indeed, across the continent. The Three Sisters — corn, beans, and squash — are planted together, as the nature of each individual plant helps the others grow, much like three sisters nurturing and supporting each other. Corn is planted in the center of a mound, and the beans and squash are planted at the base. As older sisters often do, the corn provides support for the beans to climb through the squash vines, winding their way up the cornstalks toward the sunlight. The beans hold the sisters close together, pulling nitrogen from the air and bringing it

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to the soil to nourish all three plants. The squash spreads along the ground, her large leaves shading the roots and preventing weeds from growing, the prickly hairs of the vine deterring pests. The three plants have been cultivated to withstand even the harshest of winters and the shortest of harvesting seasons. Individual tribes have carefully preserved the genetic integrity of a wide variety of each of these sisters; corn varieties in particular are protected from hybridization, as tribes have sacred ceremonial uses for their specific ancient strains in addition to their culinary uses.

Modern agricultural sciences have broadened the variety of food that can be farmed throughout the Free Lands areas. While the Three Sisters remain at the heart of traditional cooking, they are now supplemented by an array of new and diverse crops. Through advances in communication and newly opened trade routes, farmers are able to share and exchange seeds with seedkeepers from other regions, introducing previously unavailable foods to the people of Cahokia. Tomatoes, sweet peppers, chiles, chia seeds, and melons from the Diné Repub-

lic flourish year-round in large, climate-controlled greenhouses. Fields of diverse arrays of ancient grains like amaranth and quinoa, and newly introduced vegetables like potatoes and sweet potatoes, surround the city and reach out into the Free Lands. With expanded travel to other regions, a market has also emerged for specialty food items that cannot be produced in Cahokia. Delicacies like smoked salmon from the Ti'Swaq Alliance, maple syrup from the Haudenosaunee, piñon nuts and cholla buds from the Diné Republic, are brought in by travelers and traded or presented as gifts.

In addition, vast organized ranges of buffalo, elk, deer, and antelope are managed by stewards, who use a system of game hunting permits to ensure they are kept at healthy population levels and that the meat is properly respected, obtained, handled, and transported to the city. These animals are not penned or domesticated in any way, and are still hunted in their wild habitat. Hunting is performed by both professionals who supply meat for citizens of Cahokia and by the citizens themselves. By ensuring that the wildlife population



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is healthy and free to flourish naturally, the balance between flora and fauna is maintained without disruption by human intervention.

Though modern agriculture has provided a freedom from struggle for subsistence, the people retain their traditional knowledge of the wild plants of the region that are used for food and medicine. This

connection to and communication with the land is an integral part of the identity they share on a tribal level and as inhabitants of the city of Cahokia and surrounding lands. Harvesting wild onions in springtime, berries and other wild fruits in summertime, and nuts and autumn fruits as the days grow colder is a vital and cherished part



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of social life, in addition to these wild foods being an important part of the people's diet. These plants are not so much truly wild as cultivated with a light hand, not by any specific individual but by the community as a whole through generations of stewardship.

Because there is nearly full employment, a wide range of healthy food options, a connection to the land through active lifestyle with time spent in nature, and a social safety net, citizens of Cahokia are well-fed and healthy, for the most part. The diet of the average citizen is majority plant-based, and supplemented with wild game as it is available. With a vast amount of grazing and farm land available, there will not likely be any food issues for the foreseeable future as long as the weather continues to improve.

Home cooked meals are still the most common way for people to eat, but a concept similar to restaurants has blossomed in the city where the diversely gathered tribes have access to so many ingredients and customary foods. Establishments will serve a complete pre-arranged meal on particular days, instead of a menu to

choose from. The concept of individual dining is not unheard of, but it is fairly rare; meals are intended to be shared, especially in a restaurant setting. When people visit a restaurant, they are essentially being welcomed into the home to sit at the hearth of the chef who lives and cooks there. Everyone, whether they arrived alone or with a group, enjoys the meal together as a family, with the understanding that sharing a meal under the chef's roof creates a connection among them.

Nearly all chefs are also healers, using their extensive knowledge of plant and animal medicine to prepare remedies and heal the sick in their community. When individuals visit the chef to enlist their skills as a healer, the chef provides medicines specifically suited to heal their ailment, and the individual is encouraged to stay for the meal as part of their treatment. All of the other diners attending the meal that evening offer prayers for the person's recovery and renewed strength, as the well-being of each individual is the concern of the community as a whole.



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## The Economy

Cahokia is a vast mix of peoples and goods. While heavily regulated by the Council, there is still a thriving free-market at the heart of the trade economy. In fact, Cahokia is the birthplace of the concept of abstracted money in Makasing. A unit of currency known as a nizi (the word is roughly equivalent to the word dollar) has spread across the continent as the primary monetary exchange format. While originally on hemp paper, in the last forty years it has made a full transition to digital currency and paper is generally no longer used in city limits. Paper is still sometimes used in remote communities though, so it can be obtained when needed from city run banks.

Almost anything can be purchased in the central market. There are few restrictions on purchases. Black market trade centers offer recently developed drugs, experimental cybernetics, and weapons that go beyond uses for hunting. What makes both the Cahokia economy unusual, and indeed all of the modern world a little different, is the proliferation of complex, bio-fueled 3D printers called gats. In short, basic items can all be printed at home for extremely low cost.

What can't be easily printed are customized or complex items, artistic items, technical enhancements, or anything edible. This means the market tends to be full of hand-crafters, tech savants, artisan food makers, and fringe chemists. It's a thrilling time to be an inventor in Cahokia.

## Justice and Law

Within Cahokia and most modern cities and towns, there are strict laws against theft, assault, murder, and other violent acts. However trespassing and other concepts around land ownership are much less regulated. Within Cahokia city limits, the city actually maintains stewardship.

Violence isn't always illegal. In Cahokia two or more people are allowed to engage in arranged combat, even lethal combat, so long as there is a seven day waiting period, an agreed upon location, and neutral witnesses to the agreement. This arrangement isn't considered murder, and isn't a crime. Because of this, violence is rarely more than a fist fight and murder isn't a common occurrence. Most people cool off or find other solutions before anyone is killed.

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Every city in the Free Lands has a panel of judges and those judges have the final say. Trials happen up to three times. The first time, the judge makes a decision and then explains to the person what they would need to do to reverse the decision. A second trial happens and if the judge rules the same way, the decision is final. If the decision is reversed, it goes to a third trial. These three trials can happen in one day or over a course of months, depending on the crime and evidence involved. While most people accept these judgments, many who oppose the Council believe that the judges are corrupt and favor the wealthy and the powerful.

As for justice, the Suyata have the authority to kill anyone if they believe that anyone else's life is endangered or would be if the Suyata themselves died. However, Suyata are not authorized to kill someone if they are defending themselves. Instead, they are expected to use non-lethal force to restrain the offender.

At trial, the worst sentence that can be handed down is twenty years of forced community service. In community service, the offender loses all privileges as a citi-

zen. They cannot earn money, they become a ward of the city, and they live in a city barracks. Their sole job is to do assigned labor and rehabilitation toward the community they have harmed. They are marked as an offender and lose all privileges provided by their tribe.

If an offender attempts to flee the city or escape punishment, the Suyata are sent after them. If anyone is convicted of multiple murders or is convicted multiple times of murder or other serious crimes, a judge has the option of banishment. These extreme punishments don't happen often, but when they do, there is almost always backlash against the government, usually from the offender's tribe, who feels they should have greater say in punishment or forgiveness than the city.

Rehabilitation is important in Cahokia. Serving community service is less about punishment and more about compensation and understanding. Once a sentence has been officially completed, there is a welcoming ceremony where the offender is publicly acknowledged and the aggrieved party is offered an opportunity to physically embrace them, which they often take. In general there is a sense that there is equanimity among the citizens of



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Cahokia. However, a vocal minority claims that The Council and the judges play favorites at best, and are deeply corrupt at worst.

**Natives:** Many belief systems from real world tribes are still adhered to in this world. If you're playing a Character who is a member of your tribe, we encourage you to work with your Story Guide to incorporate your beliefs and customs into the game play.

**Non-Natives:** If you are not Native, we recommend you don't really look at belief and faith in Coyote & Crow the way ancient Romans believed in gods like Jupiter or Mars or modern Christians view Jesus. Instead, do some reading on Animism, dualism versus materialism, and spiritualism. Please do not ascribe real-world Native beliefs to your Character. Feel free to leave your Character without spirituality or instead, make up something whole cloth from the materials in this book. In this way, you won't inadvertently be misrepresenting actual Native beliefs.

## Spirituality and Religion

Spirituality is important across Cahokia and throughout the Free Lands and the rest of the civilized world. Very broadly, almost everyone believes in dualism over materialism in some form. That is to say, most people believe that there is more to the world than that which can be seen or touched.

It's important to clarify here that this section describes only the broadest sense of spiritual beliefs, and only in the city of Cahokia. Just like in life, whole volumes could be written on the beliefs, practices, and spirituality of even just a small region of the world. The Great Spirit is a fairly common thread through many people of this world and She embodies Nature, the Universe, and more. Tribes and regions may have different names for the Great Spirit or different concepts about Her nature or origins. Other beings like Crow, for example, are both a singular entity and simultaneously represented by everyday interactions, such as all of the crows one can see. They can be called gods or spirits, but neither word really summarizes them. While Crow might have powers or abilities, it is still just a being of the world, like all are, and still falls under the care of the Great Spirit.

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There are dozens of holidays, traditions, and festivals in the city of Cahokia. These are observed by many tribes in various forms. In the city of Cahokia especially, these celebrations are reasons for tribes to join together collectively, away from their specific tribal practices.

**Winter Rebirth:** This is a conglomeration of many different beliefs and traditions. In Cahokia, it's a seven-day long celebration in two parts. The first three days are somber, a time for prayer, fasting, and contemplation. This is to remember all who fell during the time of the Awis, and the great sacrifices that were made to stay alive. It is a time when people thank many of the animals and spirits that helped their ancestors along the way. The fourth day is the Winter Solstice, the shortest day and the longest night of the year. During this day, families and friends gather to spend time fasting and preparing food. Small gifts are often exchanged and are almost always practical items. This is a day of solidarity and unity, of human beings banding together in their darkest time. The next three days are celebrations. Food is eaten, little work is done, games are played, marriages are performed, and many children are

conceived. It is a time of rebirth and resilience.

**Dancing Bears:** This tradition is practiced across many tribes in many different ways. During the three days of Spring Equinox (the day before, the day of, and the day after), unmarried adults of all genders make ostentatious displays toward intended(s) to display their suitability as a partner. It often involves elaborate costumes, dances, and parties. At the parties, individuals open to partnership sit in a large open circle while individuals seeking partnership dance, cook, and sing for those they intend to pursue. There is no sense of obligation or judgment involved. If an





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individual approves of someone's advances, they approach them privately after the festival is over.

**Fire Festival:** There are many forms of this event and when it is celebrated varies slightly between tribes, cities, and continents. In Cahokia, and many other places, it is celebrated for five days, roughly between the Fall Equinox and the Winter Solstice. During this time, many people costume themselves as animals or spirits and often pretend to be those spirits. This is done with good humor on the surface, but underneath is a sense of reverence and of paying homage to the animals and spirits represented. Without the Great Spirit,

many believe that appeasing the animals and spirits is about keeping allies close and not angering enemies. In addition, there are a number of feasts; people often have large gatherings to share recipes and food. This tradition honors the time when heading into winter often meant that it might be the last good meal people eat for many months during the harsh cold of the Awis. The name is a generic one and many people have a culturally specific name for this festival and the traditions that go with it.

**Great Spirit's Day:** This occurs over Summer solstice and is a very serious day in most cultures. It represents the time at which most people pray for the return of the Great Spirit and thank their mothers for carrying on during dark times. Ways to celebrate include doting on their mothers, fasting, prayers, songs, sacred dances that are performed publicly only on this day, special meals prepared once a year, and extended solitary walks into the wilderness. Even for those who no longer believe that the Great Spirit left them to fend for themselves, this holiday is a reverent and solemn one. Violence isn't tolerated on this day and no nation in Makasing has violated this



premise by waging war since the date became a common one to celebrate more than 400 years ago.

## Education

Organized general education within Cahokia and throughout Makasing is relatively new compared to many of the other advances and changes that have occurred over the last few hundred years. It wasn't until around the year 350 that there was a real advancement. At that point, math was sacred and was borderline becoming a religion. But in Cahokia, there was a mathematician who disagreed with their peers, saying that its very sacredness was the reason math needed to be shared with everyone. In a passionate speech, they convinced their peers that because math was everywhere, in every aspect of life, that people should at least be able to see the beauty of it and to understand it.

Up until that point, education was extremely compartmentalized and structured in an apprenticeship-style format that often led to knowledge being siloed within certain groups and families. Once the mathematician opened up

their school to anyone who wanted to attend, attitudes began to change. The space that was used to teach math was used as a dance hall afterward and many of the students there to learn math began to stay for dance. Slowly but surely, this program expanded and became a university. Parallel developments were happening in other major cities as well.

Now, people from all walks of life who have expertise in their fields often take time, anywhere from a year to a few years, to go to a university and teach. Few individuals make a lifetime of teaching, however.

Children are often educated at home around 11 or 12. Once they and their family feel they are ready for more, they are allowed to begin attending university and taking classes they are drawn to. While people still often end up in the professions of their parents, it is not looked down on to break away and do something different. There are no degrees or certificates given out, but people do base their expertise on a topic around how many years they studied it at university. Education at the university level is funded entirely through the Cahokia government.



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## Science

In the past 400 years, nothing has changed the daily life of everyone on the planet more than the rapid advance of technology, not even the Adanadi. Some people believe the two are entwined, but it's important to note that technology and devotion to sciences were well underway before the Adanadi was utilized in its current form. In fact, without a deep understanding of the world, the true power of the Adanadi would likely never have been unleashed.

Most people in Cahokia and indeed, much of Makasing, live a daily life

filled with both science and spirituality and the two do not conflict.

In the scientific world, there isn't much direct international or internal cooperation between groups. It's an unregulated environment and technology can come in flares; individual scientists can often work for years entirely on their own. There is also a tendency for scientists to go a little slower, despite their lack of regulation. It's not a lack of ambition, but instead a sense of curiosity that drives most scientists. This does sometimes lead governments, businesses, and organiza-



tions to feel like scientists don't work fast enough on certain projects. For the most part, governments are not yet drivers of science and are often reactionary to new discoveries.

## Time

Time is looked at very differently between cultures and the world of Coyote & Crow. The Awis caused years of darkness and cloudy skies. Without the stars or the sun as a constant, many cultures struggled with not just things like calculating seasonal changes, but even tracking the general passing of years.

While some explicit records were kept, especially in Azayang and the Ezcan Empire, it was centuries after the Awis before accurate record keeping came along. That had much to do with a Two-Spirit mathematician in the Diné Republic. Their revelations regarding the number 12 changed everything, including how everyone in the world eventually tracked time. Time is tracked in years, starting from the Awis at year zero. Each year is broken into twelve months. Different nations have designated different names for these months, but they're often named after important spirits, animals, or cere-

monies. The first seven months have 30 days in them. The last five months have 31. Each day is made up of 12 segments, what we might call hours. Each hour is broken down further into 12 segments and so on.

These changes are superficial mathematical changes though. More important is the perception of time. Non-Natives might see themselves moving through time the way they might move through space while traveling up an escalator. The escalator is already moving. They step on. They are now moving forward in time. There is only one direction the escalator moves in and you are along for the ride even if you walk up it. You don't ever pass something you passed previously. However, the people of Coyote & Crow see things a little differently. They might see themselves as being on a treadmill. The conveyor is still moving, they are still walking. But the conveyor itself is a cycle, a circle, moving in place underneath the walker. Each new year isn't the next in a line, it is a restart back to the beginning. While this won't affect your general gameplay, it is important to note that we can all live in the same world and still see time very differently.



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## Culture

Cahokia, probably more than any other city in the world of Coyote & Crow, is a continuous, glorious clash of culture. Hundreds of tribes celebrate thousands of traditions. Some overlap, and citizens have plenty of shared interests and pastimes. Many popular things in Cahokia transcend tribes and are things that help unite the citizens of the Free Lands.

As a hub city representing a myriad of cultures, it is both a good example of general culture, and a totally unique mixture not found elsewhere. Addressed below is a vast generalization and should only be applied to Cahokia.

## Art

In Cahokia, art as a distinct activity had a late start. Instead, art is infused with the design of everyday objects, and permeates daily life. Because it began as a functional trade location, inter-tribal art exchanges were not the first priority to many struggling to survive. Eventually a slow trade developed and some pioneering artists took up residence, hoping to use Cahokia as a way to get their art to a wider audience than

just their tribes, testing the idea that art could simply be art for arts sake.

This was first met with a backlash from some tribes, as art styles and practices were considered personal, private, and sometimes sacred. Much art still is. Yet new styles developed, especially with the refinement and production of hemp paper and canvas, and then digital technology. While the most globally-known art often comes from the Ti'Swaq Alliance region of the continent, Cahokia has become a place known for displaying and selling art, as well as cultivating the status of new artists.



In a world where 3D printing provides all the prerequisites for survival, handcrafted items imbued with personality and history, even practicality, are highly respected. Many people who live in cities proudly own unique pieces of art from outside their tribe, often because they feel they have a direct connection with the artist or to the artist's tribe. However, most would not have a piece of art on their wall or in their wardrobe from a different tribe simply because they liked the way it looked. It is always respectful to know the artist, their background, and the meaning behind the piece. That said, there are movements within the art world that are starting to buck those trends. Some younger artists believe that art doesn't have to have separate, independent meaning, but can simply exist for its own sake.

## Music

Throughout the continent, tribes built music based on drums, vocals, and wind instruments. String instruments exist but never caught on in any real fashion and continue only in obscurity. A smattering of other instruments are usually used in support of the primary three. By the 7<sup>th</sup> Century,

complex percussion and wind instruments dominated most music in Cahokia. Vocals varied from solo singers to large choruses. More traditional messages and themes in songs are still popular — ancestors, important moments in history like the Awis, being thankful for various things, etc — but currently there is an upswing of songs about personal experiences — romantic, political, philosophical — and songs about the Adanadi and about the world outside of traditional geographic borders.

Socially, music is vital to most tribes and nations. Most citizens participate in music in some fashion — for holidays, festivals, and ceremonies, among other reasons. Musical groups do exist and tour, however there are few that make a living that way. Part of that is due to the fact that music isn't considered owned by anyone, so no one person or band can profit from claiming an individual song. Anyone can duplicate a song or improve on it. Anyone can transmit a recorded piece of music for free with permission from the artists and in some cases, the tribe.

Recorded music is only ever listened to virtually and privately



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while using Second Eyes. Any music listened to in a public setting is always done by live artists, even if they are using synthesizers or other electronic instruments. No one programs, pre-records, or lip syncs in Cahokia.

There are genres of music that cover all types of styles. The lack of ownership over songs though has created a drive within the music world to sound different or innovative enough that other artists can't duplicate their sound. In this way, musicians are able to differentiate themselves and become recognizable. Musicians in this world are often healers and music is just a part of what they want to

bring to people. They see themselves as altruistic, bringing their songs, spirits, and power to listeners in a humble fashion.

There is also a strong tradition of satire and politics in music. Musicians often write songs that slam tribes, individuals, or governments for decisions. They sing about corruption, murder, controversies, and do so in a way that often spread incredibly fast, raising awareness of social issues. Prior to modern communication, song was one of the fastest ways to transmit news. A more recent development is musicians writing comedy songs; sometimes meant to convey funny para-



bles, but also often poking fun at political or popular cultural figures.

Lastly, it's important to note that some music isn't about lyrics conveying a specific message or story. Instead, the song is simply about a feeling, a connection, and the sounds are meant to tap into something deeper than can be conveyed with language. These songs are there to connect to something higher.

## Comedy

The people of this world, just like real-world Indigenous people, have a tremendous sense of humor. Born through a combination of personal struggles and keen observation of the world around them, laughing is a vital part of almost every tribe and nation in Makasing.

There is a huge tradition of humor that comes from storytelling. Comedians of Cahokia are closely tied to poets and they both use very specific cadences. For comedians, the idea is to tell a complete story while making the listeners laugh along the way. They don't want to ever stop telling the story, so they have to pace their story in a way that the audience

stops laughing long enough to keep up with the important parts. Comedians are often judged by how long their stories are and by how long they can keep their audiences both laughing and following along. Some of the best comedians can tell stories that last for more than three hours, keeping their audience in stitches the whole way through.

The typical career trajectory for comedians is to begin in the seedier clubs of Nabanamo. Mid-level comedians are often part of arena events, and the most highly regarded comedians perform in hospitals as part of the healing process.

## Poetry

Unlike comedy, most poetry is short in Cahokia and the surrounding region. Finding the right words for a poem from across dozens of languages means that most poets are multi-lingual and freely switch languages within a poem where needed. The poems in this world cover everything from love, death, politics, the weather, spirituality, sex, and family. Short poems are often no more than four or five words, while longer ones cap out near 100. Poetry nights are popular in Cahokia at smoking dens.



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## Theater

Theater in Cahokia developed from re-creation of fables and myths into modern storytelling. Styles and presentations of stories — indoor/outdoor, short form, multiple episodes — vary wildly across the continent. Most types can be found in Cahokia. The most popular stories resonate across tribes and are often recorded to be seen on Second Eyes. Many of the stories involve supernatural creatures, spirits, and ghosts. For these, technology has allowed elaborate special effects and costumes. Modern plays are very visual displays of fantastical stories and many involved in theater are deeply invested in using the latest technology to add greater layers of fantasy and excitement to their stories.

## Sports

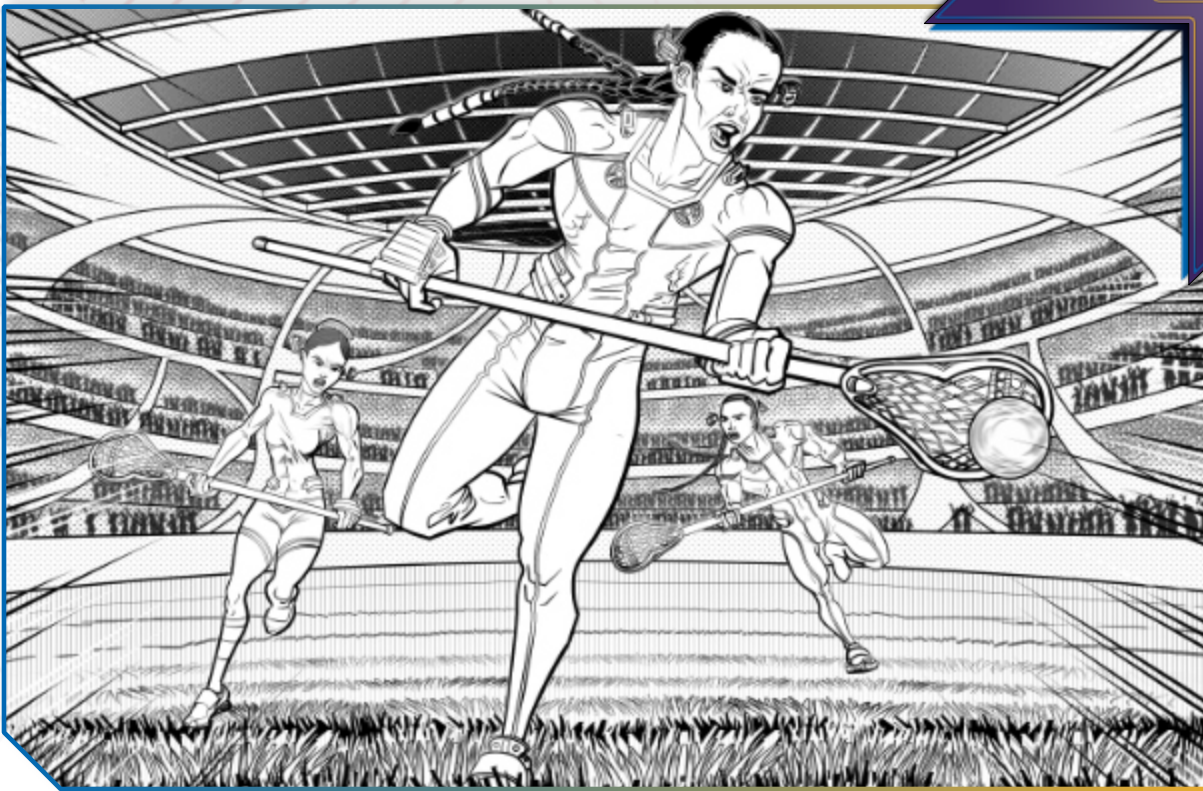
Sports and athleticism are intensely important in Cahokia. As a cultural hub, the city and its neighbors have adopted sports from around the world. Sports, rivalries, and a culture of competition run deeply through Makasing and all of the world. Sporting victories can be held over the heads of the losers for years. Modern

athletes under the influence of the Adanadi tend to be very over-powered and often have short careers. Beyond the elite professionals, sporting play and more friendly levels of competition run deep in all societies across Makasing. The mix of people in Cahokia means that dozens of sports are played at a wide variety of levels, from children's leagues to casual adult play to elders.

These are just a few of the sports played and attended in Cahokia.

- **Chunkey:** This game involves rolling a small ceramic hoop away from the active player, who then throws a spear-like object attempting to come as close to the hoop as possible, or through it, before the hoop stops rolling.
- **Ollama:** A game with origins in Azayang, this game is played on a court by two teams and is a competition to deliver a hard rubber ball through opposing goals. With hard surfaces and a dense, heavy ball, this game has come under scrutiny lately for being potentially too violent to continue being played. Nevertheless, it's also a game that people wager heavily on. Some of the star players who last more than a season are hailed as heroes by their fans, tribes, and nations.

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- **Tawaraton:** Similar to lacrosse, this game is played extremely casually most of the time and involves tossing a ball into the air on a playing field. Two teams attempt to catch the ball in small nets attached to sticks, pass it to each other, and throw it through the opposing team's nets. However, four times a year, there are major competitions when large teams form to play in highly-ritualized events that are taken very seriously and bet on heavily.
- **Hunting:** As a sport, this is always played in a non-lethal fashion and is more niche. Hunters tag a specific animal with a temporary vis-

ual mark and the winner is the first hunter who can find the animal and put a hand on it, marking it with a distinctive temporary dye.

- **Gatchoo:** This game is played on a large open grass rectangle and involves kicking a ball from one end to the other by two teams. Like Ollama, this game has come under fire lately for being dangerous to Adanadi-powered players, who were often hurt badly when playing the game even in the centuries before they had the Gift. Despite the lethality of the sport, this sport often hosts the most attended events in all of athletics.



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- **12 Hole:** A sport that has blossomed due to technology is 12 Hole, which has its roots in Kee-toowagi marbles (and plays somewhat similarly to the game of cornhole in our world). The modern version of the game is played in a five walled arena that has altered gravity fields through the use of yutsu technology, creating a three dimensional playing field with changing levels of resistance. The game requires keen hand-eye coordination and a sharply strategic mind. It is a huge source of gambling.
- **Other Sports:** Racing Skimmers and Sunwings, foot races, marathons, tracking competitions, archery, wrestling and other fighting style competitions, and dancing are all done competitively in various forms and at various levels of professionalism.

## Games and Leisure

In the past, and to some degree currently, sports took the place of war. It was a way to release physical aggression without going to actual war. It also allowed people a sense of pride or to have something to hold over their rivals. As the climate has eased, and the burdens of food and survival have lifted, people are increasingly finding the time to enjoy more

leisurely activities. No longer restricted to specific holidays or festivals, the pursuit of casual fun is something rapidly growing in Cahokia and many places around Makasing.

Cahokia offers a wide array of things for people to do when they are not working. It's important to note that alcohol and the culture around alcohol in our world doesn't exist in this world. That does not mean there aren't social equivalents, but there aren't bars,, pubs, or breweries in Makasing.

Game lodges are increasingly popular and can be thought of as a parallel to pubs and bars in our world. Games played in these lodges are often board games, but are not limited to that. There are games that use dice, cards and other pieces. There are games that require acting or social skills. Others involve physical dexterity. Some are played in five minutes while others might take place over days. One of the most popular games currently in Cahokia is called Sky's Voice. It is a dice based game where instead of numbers, the symbols on the six sided dice represent stars in the sky. As a player rolls the dice, they match them into fictional constellations

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that tell stories about the birth, life, and death of a fictional world based on the star patterns. Players vote on who told the best story. Another popular game is one where players roll twelve sided dice and attempt to get a high score without busting.

Dance clubs proliferate in the Chizi and Nabanamo districts with a fair few in the district, catering to those who are in the district for work or play. Dance is a very popular pastime in Makasing, often bordering on obsession. Musical tastes and new styles are constantly shifting. Even the number of dance clubs in the city at any given time is impossible to estimate, as clubs are constantly closing as others spring up like mushrooms overnight. A few of the most popular genres include:

- **Kamayak:** Love Music - evolved from Plains flute music, although electronics are often now an important component. The theme of Kamayak is love and seduction. Kamayak clubs frequently feature heavy elements of romance and seduction, though non-romantically-inclined individuals favoring Kamayak music often visit as well. While many individuals visit Kamayak clubs expecting hook-ups or lasting romances, romantic or

sexual intent is not necessary to enjoy Love Music.

- **Tomoyak:** Thunder Music - is a passionate musical genre featuring drums and highly complex vocal arrangement. Tomoyak clubs host a style of dance that is both freeform, highly athletic, and sometimes gymnastic in style.
- **Totsakonayaki:** Rapid Fire Music - is a genre of fast-paced electronic music usually associated with angry young people. A degree of drugs and violence is more associated with Tutsakunayake, although no one disputes the musical talent necessary for those who perform at these clubs.
- **Soomoyak:** Lung Music - is essentially highly complex choral music that has become increasingly sophisticated over the years. This style and the accompanying dance genre is appreciated by both young and old, but is often associated with the nostalgia of Elders.
- **Yawpon Mayak:** Psychedelic Music - although the name literally means tea music, the deeper connotation is the late night mind-altering substances added to the popular drink, yawpon tea. These clubs are popular among intellectuals and artists and are frequently the centers of all sorts of innovation.



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- **Nanipana Olowan:** Bragging Song- is a form that combines poetry with drum and electronica. It is highly energetic and associated with an experimental form derived from traditional dance. Both cutting edge and chic, much new fashion comes from Nanipana Olowan bands and dancers alike. Many popular Nanipana Olowan bands come from rural agricultural communities and play to packed clubs in Makasing.
- **Wohbya:** War Song - A highly rigid but highly aggressive genre based on drum and voice. It goes hand in hand with competitive dance. The standards are high, and while some people consider the genre “stodgy,” clubs are incredibly popular, as much for the dancing as for the music.

Smoke lodges dot every neighborhood in Cahokia. While the overriding spirit of the smoke lodge is religious, they also serve as social organizations and benevolent societies; members use these spaces to work together to achieve aims beyond the ability of individuals. Many smoke lodges trace their origins to the second founding of the city, while others are fairly new associations that have only been around for a few decades. Conflicts can and do arise in smoke lodges, particularly when it

is felt the lodge’s leadership is faltering morally by becoming greedy, vain, arrogant, or in some other way self-seeking.

Sweats take place all over the city, pretty much anywhere people live or work, and are taken very seriously. Families may sweat together, or friend groups, or co-workers. It is an act of trust and hospitality to invite an acquaintance or associate, let alone a stranger, to join a sweat. Sweats run continuously outside all the city's hospitals. Sweats as a whole aren't presided over by any official hierarchy, although elders, of course, are honored and deferred to. The leader of each individual sweat is the organizer, who is as much a servant as a leader. During the sweat, participants speak as they are moved to about each other's struggles and stumbling blocks, spoken and unspoken. It is considered deeply transgressive to discuss what was said inside a sweat outside the sweat. To take part in a sweat with another person is profoundly intimate.

Yawpon Houses, like the popular spot Hooba, are frequented by every level of society. Although Yawpon Houses can be found in every neighborhood, the majority are located in Nabanamo district.

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During daylight hours, most of these tea houses are sedate places to get a nice drink containing mild stimulants as well as assorted delicacies. Depending on the Yawpon House, the service can be very formal or fairly casual. As the sun goes down however, the atmosphere shifts and all but a few Yawpon Houses offer a variety of mind-expanding additions to their lowkey daytime fare. The use of psychedelic substances has been

seen by some as pivotal in the Cahokian people's ability to adapt to a series of upheavals and dramatic shifts. Keeping one's thinking from becoming too rigid is respected as long as use does not inhibit daily functioning. Of course the less respectable Yawpon houses, like Pahtsi's, serve mind-altering substances from sunrise to sunrise and are seen as gathering places for the lost and struggling.





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## Daily Life

### Medicine and Health

In Makasing, the lines between physical, mental, and spiritual wellness blur or simply don't exist at all. While there are certainly specialists, most practitioners of healing in Cahokia recognize that their area of expertise is not necessarily the only path toward helping a patient. When discussing health in Makasing, it's common to discuss it holistically, covering all areas of a patient's life. There aren't any cure-alls or perfect solutions to the complex problems behind mental health issues, but there's very little stigma attached to them. It's quite common for someone in pain to be treated by physical, mental, and spiritual healers, all of whom are working in tandem.

There are multiple distinct paths to being treated for physical injuries or illness in Cahokia – public, private, traditional, and modern. First, patients have the option for free medical treatment from the city. Cahokia society sees providing medical care as keeping a member of the community active and productive, which benefits all. There is a focus on preventative medicine and keeping people healthy.



Patients also have the option of private health care. This is paid for with nizi or gifting. Some doctors and healers in the private sector claim to be better or have more training, but there's little evidence of that. It's mostly personal preference and a sign of wealth. Patients can also choose from traditional or modern medicine, or hybrids. Cahokia recognizes both equally and patients are free to choose whichever they would like. While traditional methods, which include herbalism and prayer, don't totally eschew technology, they do keep it at arms length. Conversely, modern medicine almost ignores traditional medicine outside of the Adanadi, which proponents of modern medicine see as a cure for everything and at the root of all progress. This has created a subset of people who believe the Adanadi is actually dangerous, despite generations of use.

Modern science has also led to the ability to create high-tech prosthetic and micro solutions to many problems. However, many people are ambivalent about the idea of artificially modifying their bodies. A person who loses their arm in Cahokia is far more likely to just adapt to having one arm then get a cybernetic replacement.

## Sex and Sexuality

Sex in Cahokia manifests in several different ways, which sometimes overlap. Within the society of Cahokia, there is no judgment when it comes to sexual orientation, and no stigma surrounding casual sex between enthusiastically consenting parties. Outside of Cahokia, smaller towns, tribes, and subcultures have varying views on sexuality – for example, one village's culture maintains that sexual attraction to all is the proper norm and cutting yourself off entirely from any gender is unnatural. For many, casual sex centers around pleasure without commitment. Partners need not commit to each other, only truly consent to their time together. Likewise, no stigma exists for those individuals who choose not to engage in sexual activity, or who feel no sexual or romantic desire or inclination.

While much of the culture of all peoples in Coyote & Crow has been greatly affected by the Awis and for generations, people had to carefully balance the population between too few to survive and too many to feed. Now however, the population is exploding. Mortality has plummeted, including



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infants, and life expectancy is skyrocketing. With no recent wars, famines, or plagues, the population is growing so fast that governments are somewhat alarmed. While there is no current law against having any number of children in Cahokia, the city is debating regulation or taxation before things get out of hand.

The average family has three children and the average gestational parent gives birth to four children over their lifetime. In Cahokia, having children is a very conscious choice. Birth control regardless of gender is at nearly 99% efficacy and accidental pregnancy is very rare. As such, having sex for procreation is a very deliberate choice and may be loving and romantic, a familial obligation, a lo-

gistical decision, or any number of other reasons. Tribal and cultural traditions vary wildly when it comes to these kinds of obligations and many of them are adapting to new norms.

Ceremonial sex, while no longer as common as it once was, still exists within Cahokia society. Some people see it as a throwback or an outdated practice. Among some tribes or individuals, sex to consummate a marriage is expected. This is always a consensual act and it's almost always brief, similar to the way an enemy might begrudgingly shake their opponent's hand. Other times, it's part of a ritual. While ceremonial sex should be pleasurable, its main focus is to appeal to certain spirits or respect certain customs. Most



of the time it is a private affair, but there are certain rituals where it is done in view of others or in a more orgiastic setting.

As time has progressed and modernization becomes more commonplace, these ritualistic versions of sex are becoming both less common while also conversely becoming less of issue for people who aren't participating. Many just shrug and say things like, "That's just what they do in that tribe. No one's getting hurt, so who cares?"

## Gender

It's important to remember that while the people of this world have the same ancient history we do, they also have different customs and perceptions, even from real world Native Americans. To the people of Coyote & Crow, gender isn't just a spectrum, it's also less important culturally. Part of that is because gender roles are not as strictly enforced, but also because traditionally, those that do not conform to standard binary labels of man or woman have often been considered blessed or in possession of a greater connection to the spirit world.

In addition to any existing terms or ideas about gender which you may utilize in your game, a few easy umbrella categories exist in Coyote & Crow: women, men, and tahood (or "third"). The word is an in-world term which covers everything in our world that is not cis men or women, including Two-Spirit, trans, non-binary, and more.

It's important to note some overall things about gender in Cahokia (and most of Makasing). Gender isn't assigned to infants or children; children present however they like and may assume, combine, or change gender identities freely, including not actively acknowledging a gender for themselves or at all. There's no real stigma around a person changing their gender identity at any point in their lives.

**Native Players:** Feel free to assign your Characters a Two-Spirit identity if you feel playing that role is appropriate for you.

**Non-Native Players:** Please do not assign yourself a Two-Spirit identity.



## » VOWS

- » *Wayata of the Long Haired clan and Uugi Luss of the Turtle, have pledged themselves in marriage. All members of their families have blessed this union, and great honor has been given from their elders and council.*
- » *Wayata, as a warrior, has been accepted into her Wife's clan of Turtle, and so any children they may have will be known as Turtle. Uugi Luss, having adopted her nephew Atdanii, has put him as her first born and heir. This is known and accepted by all.*
- » *They have both agreed to move to Uugi Luss' home, within the compound of the Turtle clan. Wayata, married into Turtle now, will now be formally instated as a Turtle warrior. Her honors as a Long Hair warrior will follow her, and her rank will stay the same.*
- » *Wayata and Uugi Luss have come before The Great Spirit and have asked for the chance to build a home and hearth. Let it be known that all who stand before this couple have blessed them, and hope to see this marriage prosper.*

## Marriage and Family

Marriage is a very broad description covering hundreds of tribal traditions in Cahokia. In the most comprehensive sense, it is a union between two or more consenting adults to care for and love each other. Offspring or land entitlements are not automatically part of this equation. Relationships are usually non-hierarchical and few are prescribed as permanent. Instead, they're often evaluated at intervals and recommitted to as appropriate.

Because of the nature of marriage in Cahokia, the attitude towards it, and because of the efficacy of birth control, children are not often born without intention of marriage. Committed pair relationships are the most common, but far from the only relationship types, and the composition of that relationship varies widely. Many couples — or other combinations of partners — marry for any number of practical or logistical reasons and not necessarily for romantic love.

Because casual sex is socially acceptable, people do not feel compelled to have a long-term relationship with every person with whom they are sexually involved.

# MAKASING AND BEYOND

It is therefore not uncommon to see very close friends marry, while having occasional sexual/romantic dalliances outside of the relationship. Unless sexual and romantic fidelity is an agreed-upon aspect of the relationship, sex outside the marriage is not seen as a potential family disruption. Likewise,

partners may be romantically involved with one another but sexually involved outside the relationship, or they may simply marry for companionship at any age with no sexual or romantic component whatsoever. Many variations of love, partnership, sex or lack thereof, and marriage exist and are the norm.



The broad interpretation of marriage, as well as the intergenerational family living arrangements common in Makasing, allow for a person to work a job where they have to travel far from home, knowing that their spouse and children are being looked after while they are gone.

In Cahokia, family is rapidly climbing the list of the most important social labels, even approaching the importance of tribe. In this world, lineage is important, even if not as crucial as it used to be. Knowing your cousins, second cousins, and familial lineage is almost a default. Few people are raised by total strangers and no one would refuse to take in a child who was vaguely related. Thus, households are often ten or more people, three or more generations living together. Household duties are shared and while technology



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has taken away much of the manual labor, there is still a very strong intra-family work ethic. Siblings often take care of other siblings. Grandparents, great grandparents, and increasingly, great-great grandparents are taken care of in-home. There are orphanages and elder homes in Cahokia and across the continent, but they are the exception, not the rule; strong social and medical support from the Cahokia government enables families to care for aging and disabled individuals within the home.

Because of the governmental structure of Cahokia, no family goes hungry or without a roof over their head. While the land may be controlled by the city-state, there is no shortage of overall space and most families have room to spread out and plenty of resources. While Cahokia is a mix of hundreds of tribes and traditions, the government has settled on a matrilineal organization for the purpose of record keeping and logistical purposes. Following suit, most families recognize a matrilineal family structure, even with relative equality between all genders.



## Old Age and Death

For generations in the aftermath of the Awis, the life expectancy of the population dipped into the low forties. With the arrival of better weather, technology, and the Adanadi, that has taken a drastic turn. Life expectancy is now nearing 100 years on average and the oldest known person in Cahokia is 142. The number of people living well over 120 is rising fast.

The increase in the aged is something new for the people of Makasing and it isn't something they have entirely come to terms with. It wasn't even two centuries back that a tribe might only have a dozen people over 70, all considered elders and wizened. Soon, the elderly will be the dominant demographic; it is changing everything people know about wisdom, age, and death. More and more aged members of society are finding that their voices in politics are powerful. While there is a strong culture of respecting elders and their wisdom, some younger people are starting to worry that in this new era, the aged may hold them back, or worse, hoard power. With both the young and older populations booming, there is a

looming clash between yesterday's and tomorrow's ideas.

Advances in science have transformed what it means to be older. Adult and middle-age life has been stretched out. People who would have been feeble at 70 are still vibrant, healthy, and active.

Death is a different story. Many people feel like when the Great Spirit abandoned them during the Awis, it was Death that took Her place, killing more than 50 percent of the population of Makasing in the first twenty years. During those years, tribes were often forced to leave members unburied if they were on the move. Sometimes they had to burn them rather than give time and resources to traditional burials. In the darkest of some histories, there are even worse stories.

These radical changes have altered every single tribe's approach to death. While there are still a variety of death rituals across the continent, cremation or composting has become prevalent, especially in areas of high population density, like Cahokia. There are also varying views on suicide in old age throughout the city and the region. While many believe



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it's personally not desirable, others still view it as relieving a burden from the tribe. As such, there are some who plan their death either at a specific age or past a certain milestone — like being unable to walk from a familiar point like home, to another, like a nearby river. Once they can no longer make that journey, some decide to end things for themselves, often with the help and blessings of their tribe and family.

## Life and Conception

As with all things written here, this is a generalization and is focused on Cahokia and the city states of the Free Lands. Abortion is legal and considered entirely the purview of the gestational parent. That said, because of the quality of contraception, accidental pregnancies are rare which in turn means defining the point of conception has little significance, culturally speaking.

Paternity isn't as important in society either. Because of a lack of focus on inheritance and land ownership, parenthood is generally broken into two categories: biological and cultural. Biological parenthood holds little weight, either socially or legally. Culturally,

a person who steps into the role of father for any child is seen equally or more prominent in the child's life compared to the non-gestational biological parent.

While divorce is a thing, there are not really parallel concepts of stepparents. Nor do children 'lose' parents to divorce. They simply have more than one and all parents involved interact with their children as fits that specific relationship. Children with split parents often live freely between two or more homes. Still, divorce is uncommon due to the less restrictive nature of marriage. Additionally, a maternal uncle is often as strong a parental figure to a child as the child's father.

While all life is considered sacred for the citizens of Cahokia, infants are not considered fully fledged humans until after the typical age they would stop breastfeeding. Recent changes in technology have radically altered infant mortality rates though and many people have had to face tough moral choices that they wouldn't have just a few generations ago. For example, if an infant is likely to die shortly after birth, is it acceptable to experimentally give them the Adanadi-based drugs to attempt

to keep them alive or cure them? If an infant is born deaf, is it moral to give them cybernetic implants at birth? None of these kinds of questions have clear answers yet.

With technology spreading quickly and without centralized legal control, often, if a parent doesn't like the answer a healer gives them, they can simply take a child to a different city-state or to a neighboring nation to get treatment that suits their desires. There is an ongoing debate about the rights and motives of parents in relation to invasive permanent medical procedures before their children can meaningfully consent to them..

## Tribes

Before discussing how tribes are integrated into daily life in Cahokia, we need to define what exactly a tribe is, how it relates to real world understandings of tribes, and what it means for Players with heritage indigenous to the Americas.

This needs to be stated clearly here for both Native and non-Native Players. Real world tribes and nations exist in Coyote & Crow. They are still vital, vibrant parts of the fabric of society and play an

important role. With that said, not many are mentioned in this book for some very important reasons. While the writers of this book come from a variety of tribes, we obviously would not speak for all tribes. Instead, it is our view that the fate of real world tribes in Coyote & Crow should be written in future volumes by writers from those tribes. Of course, some are mentioned either directly or indirectly in this book but usually in larger picture terms such as in the formation of nations. The detailed histories of real world tribes will not be detailed here.

As a collective label applied by the members of the tribe and by outsiders, a tribe is a group of people who share cultural, familial, and often geographic ties. As such, tribes exist in Coyote & Crow and in Cahokia specifically, but they don't exist as the dominant social unit. As previously mentioned, family is a strong social label. Additionally, being a citizen of Cahokia carries weight. Some people strongly identify as being part of a nation— or not part of a nation, as citizens of the Free Lands tend to think of themselves. Others strongly identify with their Path or clan.



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Tribes certainly still dominate certain geographic regions, and often claim control or authority over that area. But in places like Cahokia, it's understood that to partake as a citizen, citizens have to partition their tribal identity and accept that they have more than a single label. For many, this is easy to do. But some tribes have long histories of confrontation and struggles and those aren't as easily overcome.

It should also be mentioned that there are tribes that exist in Coyote & Crow that do not exist in real life. 700 years since the Awis

began putting extreme social pressures on the people of Makasing is more than enough time for tribes to not only be pushed into living together, but for generations of co-survival and alliances to create whole new tribes and subcultures. Feel free to create your own for the purposes of playing this game. Just remember to not reference real world tribes unless you claim that heritage yourself.

## Paths

There will be more on Paths in the Character creation section, but for now, what is important to know is that in Cahokia, there are fifteen common Paths, all based on animals. Since choosing a Path is a lifetime decision done at puberty when consuming the Adanadi, many feel a sense of kinship with other people on the same Path. Many also deeply connect and relate to the animal associated with the Path. There aren't many analogies for this in our real world — for Native players, this might feel equivalent somewhat to some clan structures. In addition, certain other social groups, clubs, cults, etc., base their membership on people being on the same Path or having the same Ability within that Path.

**Native Players:** If your Character is from a real world tribe, you're welcome to explore these dynamics further.

**Non-Native Players:** We ask that you not assign your Character to a real world tribe. While your Character might have one, it is perfectly plausible that the designation simply is not a part of their life that is significant to gameplay. Their citizenship, their family, and their Path can all play a vital role in how they socially identify.

## Day to Day Living

Despite all of this information, you might still be wondering what life is like in Cahokia, what people do on an average day. It isn't that far from our real world in the broad sense. People fall in love, go on dates, have children or don't. They participate in government, they go to work, either for themselves or for someone else. They make money, pay taxes, get sick, get better, and do their best to carve out lives with meaning while hopefully creating a better one for their children.

There are differences too. A forty hour work week is not a standard. There isn't a standard at all; people tend to work as many hours as are comfortable for them and their family. People are far more involved in their local politics than they are in their national politics and the idea of nationalism is an anathema to most. There isn't as much discussion or tension around social issues like sex and marriage because no dominant religious force has assumed authority over the entire region. People still get sick and injured, but it is a world with a comprehensive and readily available health system. While there are certainly very powerful companies in Makasing, most people don't work

for them and they do not have any strong political clout outside of their immediate geographical area.

All of this might sound pretty easy and straightforward, but it was a long road to get here for the citizens of Cahokia, and doesn't mean they live perfect lives in a utopia.

## The Five Nations

Commonly referred to as "The Five," there are five nations in the northern section of the continent called Makasing. On their northern border is the slowly retreating ice shelf, the Permanent Ice Zone, and to the south is the Ezcan Empire, an uneasy neighbor with a tense border and a fraught history with the Five. All five nations will be discussed below. These places will be explored in greater detail in future books. These are meant to give you a little flavor for the rest of the continent and to give you context for the world your Characters will inhabit.

This information was collected and collated by envoys from Cahokia who have traveled abroad and have returned with various observations. As such, keep in mind that these are their individual observations and may be laden with biases, faulty information, rumor, and conjecture.



## Haudenosaunee Confederacy (Hadanosani)

### Introduction

Haudenosaunee — Hadanosani in Chahi — is a powerful confederation of nation-states in the Northeast made up of dozens of people groups. If the Free Cities are the gathering place of nations, Hadanosani is the crucible. When refugees flooded the area around the sogami, the five nations who lived there formed a confederation to ensure long-term stability and maintain local dominance. Those who were willing to assimilate into the clans of the region found themselves accepted as equals. When Haudenosaunee began waging war against the smaller tribes that surrounded their homeland, they too were integrated into the broader confederacy — not as assimilated individuals, but as quasi-independent vassal states. When the All Tribes War broke out, captives from the Keetoowagi Federation and the Free Cities were offered citizenship and integrated into the clans that captured them in battle. As a result, the five founding nations

have forged a motley assortment of refugees, conquered nations, and willing allies into the most populous and cosmopolitan nation on the continent.

### Government and Politics

Haudenosaunee is ruled by a Grand Council that operates via consensus-based principles that extend throughout all levels of government. There is no single head of state, but the five original nations each elect a Sachem to serve on the Grand Council. No major decision can be made without unanimity among these five. Similarly, legislation is determined by the Council of Sagamores, a bicameral body composed of two houses of 56 members each. The senior house, Kanonhsa Lakoia, is composed entirely of women and has the power to remove members from the lower house. The lower house, Kanonhsa Rake, is composed of men. In order for any piece of legislation or treaty to be passed, both houses must agree to it and 75% of the members of each house must approve the legislation.

## Economy and Technology

The cities of the northeast are some of the most densely populated on the continent. As the Five Nations amassed inhabitants from the north, their immediate environs, and eventually the far reaches of Makasing, their historical homelands became powerful centers of trade, diplomacy, and finance. Today, the largest single megapolis in the continent lies between the eastern shores of Esogami and the eastern seaboard. Much of the cities' success is owed to the Algonquin refugees who came to form a crucial component of the trading class, building trade routes and canals that connect the Haudenosaunee heartland to the Free Cities.

Technology in the Confederacy is eclectic, with significant inventors contributing to agriculture, communications, and warfare over the years. Daso technology owes a particular debt to the Hadenosani. Some of the base contributing technologies originated as methods to extend markets and integrate far-off subordinates. Additionally, centuries of conquests have led to entire industrial bases being incorporated into the Haudenosaunee war machine, which once threatened the entire continent.

## Society and Culture

In many ways, Haudenosaunee is incredibly tolerant. Anyone can become a full-fledged citizen, regardless of the circumstances of their birth, including former prisoners of war. However, for those who choose not to assimilate and choose to retain their own practices, languages, and beliefs, disenfranchisement is almost total. While Chahi remains an important aspect of trade, those who speak it as a first language often suffer as second-class citizens in a Confederacy that prides itself on cultural legacies that extend back before the Awis.

At the top of the Haudenosaunee social schema are the Yavi, hereditary descendents of powerful individuals from the inception of the Confederacy. Not only do they enjoy a privileged role at home, but they also operate as major power brokers across the continent. At the bottom are the Unlad, primarily migratory descendants of Cree and Anishinabe peoples who have taken on roles as international traders and domestic workers without fully integrating into the rest of the Nation.



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Descendants of mixed blood, called Gatli, have their own distinct culture and role within Haudenosaunee society. There are a handful of towns, primarily along the northern border, inhabited entirely by Gatli. Although these towns have resisted full assimilation, they have been granted partial enfranchisement. All non-assimilated Gatli voters vote for a single seat in the lower house, and a non-voting representative to the Grand Council. This largely ceremonial role has accumulated power over the years, and now serves as an intermediary between other members, often helping to resolve deadlocks. In everyday life, many Gatli work in the dangerous business of exploring the northern permafrost to study and collect unusual manifestations of the Gift and difficult to obtain ores and elements.

## Factions and Groups

**Keepers of the Fire:** A hereditary society that holds no official power, but tremendous political influence. The Keepers perform the ceremonies that invest government officials with power, remove them from office, and inaugurate and dissolve each legislative session. They also serve as the de facto regulators of Adanadi.

**Mingo:** When members of the Five First Nations moved westwards, a few of their number stayed in the area to dispense a brand of frontier justice. Today, their successors are known in some parts as brave lawmen who preserve order between the cities. To others, they are vigilantes or bandits themselves, extorting travelers and traders and leaning on their heritage to escape legal consequences.

**Kari Kehro:** Builders and engineers, the members of Kari Kehro are the foundational political force in Haudenosaunee cities. With control of the labor market comes control over political favors; control over political favors brings incredible wealth, which in turn helps solidify control over the labor market. This political machine often hires freelancers to enforce their power in extra-legal ways.

**Northmen:** Almost all Gatli, the Northmen are explorers who forge their way into the permafrost where rare flora and fauna, and the Adanadi that accompanies it, can be found. The territory they venture into is lethal to the uninitiated and takes more than a few Gatli lives every year. In return, the North provides the fuel that has

kept Haudenosaunee strong for generations and the Gatli relevant in a society that would gladly see the eradication of their culture.

## Major Cities and Locations

- Tadodahan: Capitol city
- Chalakatha: Major Unlad city built on six hills
- Karonto: Northernmost city and ancestral homeland of the Gatli
- Saginaw: One pole of the Hadenosani megapolis, on the east coast
- Ganadag: The western end of the megapolis, serving as the ceremonial center of Haudenosaunee

## Ti'Swaq Alliance

### Introduction

The northwestern coast was spared much of the Awis and its people adapted quickly to the consequences that ensued. The sea, once calmed, returned her bounty to the people. While their crops wilted, they did not starve. Today, technological innovation continues to fuel prosperity. The Ti'Swaq are not mighty militarily among the nations, but their wealth and influence are a force that cannot be ignored. Even Ca-

hokian fashions, dress, theater, and Second Eyes entertainment are influenced by trends that first emerged in the far west. A Ti'Swaq abroad needn't look far to see echoes of home, but seeking new experiences is a national pastime for those who can travel.

## Government and Politics

Unlike the largely democratic nations of Makasing, Ti'Swaq retains a hereditary ruler. A complex system of spiritual, military, and political power provides the framework by which former enemies stand united. When raiders from the north fled south following the Awis, the courageous weaver Sholeetsa brought warring factions together. Ever since, the eldest daughters of her eldest daughters have continued to ceremonially host potlatches that bring the nation's nobility together. They convene the most powerful figures in Makasing and provide instruction that guides the nation. While anti-monarch sentiments have arisen from time to time, freedom of movement and economic prosperity have generally led to stability, as have democratic reforms that have allowed many local hereditary rulers to be replaced with elected autocrats.



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Looking abroad, the Ti'Swaq enjoy largely peaceful relations with the other nations of Makasing. The deserts and basins to the south historically separated them from the Diné, and the wide and spacious plains to their east have facilitated more trading competition than violent conflict with the Free Cities.

## Economy and Technology

When the cultivation of the Adanadi came, the Ti'Swaq assimilated slower than some others. Their gifted children were rare and they were slower to cultivate

the mark among their plants and animals. As a result, the Ti'Swaq are only now widely integrating The Gift into larger society. Without broad use of the Gift, the Ti'Swaq had to push harder for technological advancement, but their cunning revealed an opportunity. Other nations developed grand machines; the Ti'Swaq kept their attention on more portable technologies. While other nations harness the sun, the Ti'Swaq invented compact and powerful batteries. While others built airships, the Ti'Swaq perfected the gats that the other nations now rely



on, and still produce the strongest synthetic materials to supply them. While others developed weapons, the Ti'Swaq developed the initial code to harness the dasu. Through cunning and diligence they remain a technological force respected far and wide.

While they have an excellent fleet of ships with a hardened group of sailors and navigators, their success along the coasts has made them somewhat reluctant to explore too far to the north. Many feel that keeping the status quo is more valuable than taking unnecessary risks. As such, the economy is increasingly insular and more focused on preservation than expansion. The hills, mountains, and forests that dominate Ti'Swaq have broadly remained free from economic cultivation. The bulk of the nation's farmland is nestled between the hills to the east. Cities are found in small clusters in the west, along the Whulge Sound and the bases of mountains.

There, buildings hundreds of feet long and taller than trees stand along meandering paths, with a stage or totem pole always in sight. Within each longhouse, the ground is dominated with spaces for gathering and gardens. Above,

there are hundreds of apartments with generations living side by side. Along the waters, glimmering ribbon collectors produce energy from the movement of the water and around every volcano a geothermal station. Rather than roads, yutsu barges travel as the crow flies, hovering just above dense majestic forests.

## Society and Culture

In the west, Ti'Swaq know where they stand, their caste set by their birth. Laborers, derisively called stick people, tend the factories, fields, and fisheries. Merchants serve the wants of the community and bring in trade. Aristocrats maintain diplomacy, create laws, and advise the elected Grand Chief. However, not every TiSwaqi lives in the caste they were born into. Historians and other culture-keepers maintain traditions, while artists and engineers create beauty and technologies for rich and poor alike. Walking through the emerald and glass superstructures on the coast, a visitor can almost always find someone with a couple of tools to fix your Second Eyes, a dance or trick to use at a party, or an entertainer who is going to hit their big break any day now.



The eastern portion of the nation is a more egalitarian, but less prosperous world. More humble than their cousins, traders from the Free Lands often underestimate these cunning and savvy farm bosses. Separation from the political influence and opulent wealth of the west breeds resentment and a growing wonder where the east's allegiances should lie. These dynamics actively fray the alliances that formed the nation. The poor, in the east and west, are beginning to grow weary of toiling for little reward. Meanwhile, forces work from within to control who tells the stories.

Recently, the Ti'Swaq have started to explore and settle the nearby islands revealed by the ice's retreat. Even the historians know little about what to expect and have found burial grounds long forgotten. A new science, archaeology, is developing and its practitioners seek to find the memories the islands hold.

## Major Cities and Locations

- **Si'ahl:** Major city on the sound with a rich dramatic tradition
- **Sholeetsa:** The capital at the foot of Ti'Swaq

## Diné Republic (Dinada)

### Introduction

The Diné Republic is one of the stronger and more cohesive nations in North America. This is primarily due to being on the front lines of the last war with the Ezcan Empire. While their southern border has stabilized, it wouldn't have been possible without the other four nations of Makasing contributing to that outcome. Despite that, the Diné don't generally think of themselves as a militarized nation the way the Ezcans do. The republic is spread out across a vast area and they have access to a deep well of wealthy farm land just inland from their western coast. A young Two-Spirit leader from the region is known widely as the person who invented the duodecimal math system after a weeks long fast in a darkened cave. That discovery not only led to increases in engineering, including irrigation, but ended up becoming the basis for all higher math throughout the world. It is a key reason that the number 12 has taken on sacred significance. The Diné Republic is one of the largest exporters of food and even now trades with the Ezcan Empire during the uneasy

peace. The real-world site known as Chaco Canyon isn't just the capital of the Diné Republic, called Coyote City; it is often thought of as one of the centers of philosophical and spiritual thought, perhaps only rivaled by Cahokia.

## **Government and Politics**

The incredible linguistic and cultural diversity contained within the Diné Republic demands a system of governance that affords equal respect to the peoples of the arid scrubland and those who live on the beaches of the Sikugami. As such, the vast majority of governance happens on the local level, with the clan or band as the core unit of citizen participation. Each of these units governs an area somewhere between 50-1,000 square miles. These units are represented by hereditary delegates, whose authority passes down through families matrilineally. Clans are generally afforded a wide berth and recognized as the experts on the challenges their communities face, the resources their environments provide, and the help their people need from the national government.

Unlike many other nations, there is not a significant secondary level of government. Instead, major cities, called Kivas, serve as regional meeting places for clans. The clan leaders come together on an annual basis to decide what must be communicated to the national government. These missives are then brought to the National Council by spiritual leaders, reflecting the religious origins of the Kivas themselves. On the federal level, the Diné are governed by a council made of democratically elected delegates, priests, and military leaders. This council controls foreign relations and the military, as well as commerce and trade. There is no single head of state.

## **Economy and Technology**

The economy of Diné is one of the most powerful in the known world, built off a backbone of scientific advancement. Coyote City in particular is a critical research hub for the biotechnology, agriculture, climate restoration, and studies of The Adanadi. The Adanadi in particular has been a source of tremendous prosperity for Diné, and scientists in the region have historically pushed the envelope on what has been deemed possible with the Gift.



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The Republic also plays a significant continental role in military and exploration. The Tomal Islands, off the Sikugami Coast, once served as the critical launching point for westward exploration and continue to serve as a critical military base to ward off naval incursions from Azayang.

## Society and Culture

While the Diné Republic enjoys tremendous cultural diversity, the primary religion of the nation is Hozho, or the Way. This syncretic belief system takes a holistic view of the world that is fundamentally beautiful at the core. Liturgical life for those who follow Hozho is marked by regular participation in rituals that reenact the primordial journey of the Diné out of the underworld. Those exhibiting albinism are afforded particular honor among practitioners of the Way, and more albino people live in the Diné Republic than anywhere else on the continent. Despite the strong economy and unifying faith, significant cultural fractures exist in the Republic. The most significant form of discrimination in the nation is linguistic, with Uto-Ezcan peoples afforded suspicion following the wars with Azayang.

## Major Cities and Locations

- **Yaanga:** Major city nestled in the valleys of the Western province
- **Pimu:** Military and exploration frontier city on an island
- **Coyote City:** Major research hub and capital of The Republic
- **Tseyi:** Major spiritual site and agricultural center
- **Ni Alnigi:** Ceremonial hub of the nation without permanent dwellings
- **Green Mountain:** City built into the side of cliffs which played a pivotal role in the All Tribes War
- **Oraibi:** This small town is famous for one reason: it is the oldest continually inhabited town in the known world and its establishment predates the Awis

## Factions and Groups

**Keepers of the Ancient Ones:** The Keepers are an ancient religious order who are dedicated to the preservation of ancestral knowledge. In ancient times, they were dedicated to discovering and recording petroglyphs. In more recent days, they applied the knowledge gained from the teachings of the Ancient Ones to the Gift. Today, they are represented in both

Kiva ceremonies and in the halls of academia.

**Corn Pollen Keepers:** In Diné, groves of corn are carefully and spiritually tended. The genetic lineages that emerge from this sacred science are used in a number of Diné's most significant scientific advances. Corn Pollen Keepers tend these groves. The role is typically passed down from mother to daughter, but exceptional horticulturalists are sometimes selected to contribute.

**The Twelve:** Some members of Diné society are neither male nor female. Throughout much of history, 12 such individuals are specially chosen, with a replacement nominated by a retiring individual or chosen by the rest of the cohort in the event of an untimely death. They also serve as ambassadors between different clans, cities, and regions of Diné. The Twelve additionally play a critical role as the diplomatic core of the Republic.

**Coyote Crime Lords:** Coyote City is a thriving center of biomedical research, and a hotbed of crime. The production and cultivation of various corn-based synthetics and derivatives have been a lucrative

opportunity for the unscrupulous for years, and seven clans currently divide the black market.

**The Ancients:** While the dominant spiritual philosophy in the The Republic is a modern blend of traditions that focuses on the concept of balance and harmony, a few souls have adhered to more ancient paths. In the Canyon of the Ancients, many have dedicated themselves to the ways of their own ancestors and resisted any attempts at syncretization. Though they are subject to a great deal of religious discrimination, these societies also enjoy certain legal protections and have formed a strong voice for independence, inspiring many others. In most cases these groups are entirely peaceful, though a few are more paramilitary in nature.

## Keetoowagi Federation (Kitowagi)

### Introduction

While the Federation is stable and prosperous now, it has a past that looms over it and a hazy future. The Keetoowagi Federation was the last modern nation to eliminate indentured servitude —



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something that other nations like to remind the Keetoowagi of. It doesn't matter that it's been more than 200 years. They were the last to end it.

It has only been 30 years since there was open conflict with Haudenosaunee and attitudes on both sides are still raw. While there hasn't been a full on war in more than a century between the two, there is a continual biting edge to their relations with each other, agitated by tribes and families that live across both borders, as well as age-old territorial claims.

## Government and Politics

There is an old Kitowagi proverb that goes something like “a farmer's family will never go hungry, but a lawyer's family will always be full.” The truth in that aphorism can be found in the nation's government itself. The Keetoowagi Federation is made up of six nation-states and 42 electoral provinces. The federal government is made up of two houses of officials, one for the nation states and one for the provinces, each with three members from the nation-states and electoral provinces. With a total of 144 members, it is the largest, most com-

plex governing body of the nations in the world. Each nation-state has internal treaties and binding agreements with the others, but only the federal government can negotiate with other nations. This creates a labyrinthine legal system requiring intense academic knowledge of its innerworkings. Despite that, other nations often model their legal documents, court systems, and treaty processes after the Keetoowagi, who have become known as master diplomats and legal scholars.

However, they have also received significant pushback from the other nations of Makasing for trading with the Ezcan Empire. Very specific post-war trade agreements were set up after the war ended and other nations have accused the Federation of going beyond or around those trade agreements. The government denies doing this, saying it has perfectly obeyed the letter of the treaties, even if others may think it hasn't honored the spirit of them.

The Federation also has a unique, if small, military force. While one of a few nations that has a standing military, even in times of peace, it is the only nation that uses a combined fighting force for

all situations. The soldiers in the Keetoowagi Federation military are equally trained in naval, land, and air theaters. While the military isn't currently deployed against any other nation, they are active in combating a growing piracy problem in the gulf and along the coast of the Kangami ocean.

## Economy and Technology

The Federation built its considerable wealth through ocean and inland trade — to Cahokia and Abayang respectively — as well as pharmaceuticals, herbalism, and bio-tech. Warm gulf currents helped alleviate much of the cold weather from the Awis and the tribes of the Federation were some of the first to not only unlock the potential of the Adanadi, but to begin advanced biomedical research. With an abundant variety of plant life, advances in traditional and modern medicine skyrocketed in the Federation, increasing life expectancy, the survival of wounded soldiers, recovery and prevention of disease, and more.

The Federation trades openly with other nations, revealing the ingredients, production methods, and chemical combinations that have

made their biomedical advances so potent. However, there is an undercurrent of wealthy individuals within the nation who not only believe it is wise to begin hoarding that information and only selling or trading the final products, but to actively pursue the intellectual theft of similar advances from other nations. These individuals are often referred to as etisus, or quartermasters, by others. The general populace think of these people as trying to stockpile, ration, and control important resources in a way that only profits themselves. Many of these etisus have become so wealthy and powerful, however, that they think of themselves and their employees as their own nation or tribe, separate and above others. They believe the Federation thrives because of them.

Four major pharmaceutical companies have facilities that are essentially small cities. They employ almost the entire population surrounding them, either directly or indirectly. The drugs that come out of these facilities are used around the world; they provide everything from basic pain relief to cancer-fighting drugs to combat stimulants and focused altered-state hallucinogens. These companies also have advanced private



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security forces and some whisper about a massive espionage network that spans around the world.

Fishing and water farms are huge industries throughout the entire coastline of the Federation and advanced fishing techniques provide an enormous bounty of food and more than enough for trade. These industries provide much of the internal parts of the nation with fresh fish and other regional food.

## Society and Culture

Culturally, the Keetoowagi Federation, like most of the modern nations, is built on the foundations of dozens of tribes and cultures. The two largest are the Kituwa and the Este Muskogee, both of whom had significant influence on the overall nation and its development. Sharing is at the cultural heart of many tribes of the Keetoowagi Federation, and the concept of individual private property is a new and still mostly disdained concept; hence the dislike of the etisus. That does not mean that there aren't still regional claims between clans and tribes. Often the Keetoowagi Federation finds itself squabbling internally over petty grievances that are dragged out endlessly in courts.

Mound building as a foundation of architecture is prevalent, but unlike in Cahokia, it did not result in extensive underground tunneling, as often the foundations were either too brittle or too wet. Instead, cities often spread out low and flat, which helps prevent sinking foundations. Most cities are centered around rivers or waterways. With air travel more common, there are even fewer developed ground paths between cities, towns, and rural residents. Waterways continue to be the dominant paths of travel. In the northern part of the nation, cities still have defensive fortifications and limited access points, left over from their conflict with the Haudenosaunee.

## Major Cities and Locations

- **Keowee:** Capital
- **Pensacola Bay:** One of the largest ocean ports in the world and the main access point for goods coming from Abayang on their way to Cahokia
- **Ocute:** East coast city with river access to the Kangami ocean that sees significant trade and shipping

## The Free Lands

### Introduction

While considered one of the Five Nations of Makasing, The Free Lands don't really fit into the same mold as the others, since they don't claim borders. Instead, the city-state of Cahokia leads other smaller governments in the idea that no one, and no government, can claim such large swaths of territory for themselves. The autonomy of the Free Cities and their resistance to consolidation are a point of pride for Cahokia and the smaller groups within the Free Lands. In reality, they all likely survive due to the international influence of Cahokia. The following are some of the more prominent groups found among the Free Lands. These people are made up of a variety of pre-Awis tribes and nations and now claim their own identity separate from real-world tribes.

### The Paha

The Paha people, pejoratively known as Pikwi by their neighbors, inhabit the coastal region. The Paha have a great love of trade and haggling, they also have a love of bureaucracy and details. Culturally, they are somewhat pedantic. In

earlier times, their civilization was dominant, but as the climate has begun to recover they are now suffering a loss of lands to flooding. While trade has always been vital to the Paha, these days many displaced Paha fishermen, aquatic farmers, and coastal farmers have become traders, navigating inland waterways by the use of small crafts. Among the goods provided by Paha traders are a highly sought after patterned farmed cloth, made of specially developed algae that grows in human-made tidal pools.

The flooding and loss of Paha lands has destabilized their once hereditary power structure, leading to a battle between two opposing factions: the Nhapi are led by Noopyi, a somewhat conservative trans woman descendant of hereditary female leaders. She believes it is the rational but also devout thing for the sea-faring people to accept the changes in the coastline caused by the great thawing and move further inland. Her rival Toosa is an upstart from a bureaucratic family and leads the Reclaimers. She is also a woman, but lacks the innate religious authority offered to a trans person of Paha. Toosa stresses technology and a break with the past. She and her followers want



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to reclaim the lands lost to the ocean with a bold plan for dikes and human-built islands. The Nhapi believe Toosa's plan will ultimately result in the deaths of more Paha people.

## The Anikora

The Anikora live just to the north of Cahokia. Their society is one of rigid social hierarchies and definite class divisions. They are often considered somewhat humorless by their neighbors. During the long period of cold and hardship brought about by the Awis, the Anikoras took their society underground. Unless one is aware of their existence, all signs of their city are invisible from above ground. Over the years, the Anikora have become expert architects and builders. They developed many building materials and techniques used by other peoples. They often leave their city and its surrounding area to consult on building projects. Their underground city is a beautiful, well-lit community, complete with underground lakes, springs, and fountains as well as gardens. The Anikora have a very strict but effective educational system which is reflective of their society overall; orderly, polite, and effective.

Many of the Anikora definitely believe some people are better than others.

## The Nahoonak

The Nahoonak people live at the northernmost edge of the Free-lands. These are a break-away people who were once part of the Anikora. These people are often looked at with bewilderment by the other nations as a mass of contradictions because they seem at times to be the exact opposites of the Anikora. Although they live in the coldest part of the Free-lands, the Nahoonak have long dwelt in huge clusters of clear glass domes with 12 facets, which they rarely leave. This allows them to grow as much food as they desire, and is probably how they came to be strict vegetarians. They also tend to wear minimal clothing as their dwellings are quite warm. The Nahoonak have a consensus government where every individual has a say. The contention can be very intense within the Nahoonak nation, but their loyalty to their own way of life and people is fierce. They also are known as somewhat arrogant. The Nahoonak are seen as having fiery but short-lived tempers. They are also renowned for their ability to

manipulate plant genetics and have religious prohibitions against eating either fruit, grain, or vegetable not marked with their own variations of the Adanadi. Unlike their relatives, the Anikora, it is unusual to see a Nahoonak away from their domes, as they are an insular folk.

## The Makokamit

The Makokamit people live between Cahokia and the Paha and are primarily occupied with animal husbandry, particularly buffalo, antelope, and turkey. The Makokamit have as close a relationship with their various animals as the Nahoonak have with their plants. They are also notable cooks. Because of the necessity of managing large herds of animals, the Makokamit also excel in the production of personal transport vehicles. Theirs is the most rural of the Freelands city-states with the most widely dispersed population. Unlike the other nations, they tend to spend brief rotations living in the city portion of their city state. Their government would be considered democratic, but without an authority compelling compliance to group decisions as long as they don't affect the whole. The Makokamit are more male-

dominated than most Freeland people, particularly compared to their neighbors the Paha. The Makokamit are also committed gamblers and considered the most boisterous of the Free Lands people. Although the Makokamit are considered somewhat coarse by their Paha neighbors, this is objectively an unfair characterization, as the Makokamit are keenly interested in fashion and personal ornamentation as well as music and dancing. The Makokamit are nothing if not flashy.

## The Tomoha

The Tomoha inhabit the forested area in a strip along the eastern edge of the Freelands. The Tomoha do not clear forests to build or expand their city, but rather live and work in the trees in highly developed tree houses that accommodate the growth and motion of the forest, gathering energy using the same solar technology used in Cahokia. The Tomoha were among the first people to develop human flight, and the one or two-person solar powered fliers called pehe — meaning seed, the inspiration for the flier's design — are commonly used.



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The Tomoha have a complex governmental system, consisting of a hereditary religious leader, an elected leader, and regular votes by the general population. The Tomoha are seen as very politically and socially stable by the other city-states of the Free Lands. The Tomoha are extremely egalitarian, perhaps even more so than the Nahoonak, though they are more restrained. The Tomoha value harmony as one of the great virtues. This encompasses everything from their dress to their homes, insisting that they blend harmoniously with their environment. For this reason they are sometimes referred to as The Invisible or, for obvious reasons, tree-people.

## The Nakotoo

There is a small sixth group, entirely nomadic, called the Nakotoo. They consider themselves a people, although others may consider them a nuisance or a religious cult. Many of them, or their parents or grandparents, originated as citizens of the Free Lands city-states and joined the Nakotoo. The Nakotoo are entirely traders; however, that is just their means of survival. The Nakotoo consider their real mission in life to be to balance the scales of

the universe in all ways. They travel in small bands or family groups. It might be argued that the continued existence of the Nakotoo is a monument to the tolerance of the Freelands. While the Nakotoo are happy to help any traveler in distress, they also see it as their duty to provide balance, robbing or fighting any they see as too lucky or too successful. If there is any nobility to thievery, the Nakotoo have mastered it.

## The World Beyond Makasing

### Azayang

While this region — what we in the real world think of as Mesoamerica — is technically part of the same continent as Makasing, it has its own regional name. This is primarily due to the history of large cultural, geographic, and climate differences. It is home to only two nations and they couldn't be more different from each other.

**The Ezcan Empire:** No nation in the world has been more expansionist and antagonistic to its neighbors than the Ezcan Empire, which has grown continuously every year for the last 400 years,

right up until the end of the All Tribes War. The Ezcan Empire's technology and their approach to it is vastly different than other nations. It focuses much of its effort on a nationalist zeal that frightens most other nations. That also belies the fact that the citizens of the Ezcan Empire, who almost all have ancestors who were brutally conquered by their own government, now live in relative peace and harmony. While there is a strict class system in place, topped by the military government led by the Emperor, the standard of living for everyone is high. The Ezcan Empire sees its growth as freeing people from lesser governments. The Emperor is fond of saying, "I look forward to the day I can lay down my sword because all people are Ezcan."

**Raramori:** Raramori is both the name of a people and the name of their nation. It is a tiny nation in the middle of the mountains in the northern part of the Ezcan Empire. Unwilling to be conquered, they moved into rugged terrain and have fought the Ezcans to a stalemate for centuries. Raramori are the most feared and legendary warriors on the planet. Very little is known about their se-

cretive culture, other than their enduring hatred for the Ezcans and their desire to not be conquered. Some say there are only a few thousand left. Others say there are millions hiding in deep networked caves.

## Abayang

The large and long continent dominated by sprawling and rich rainforests, majestic mountains and desolate high plains south of Azayang is known as Abayang. Home to five dominant nations, these people, each with their own unique cultures and histories, have been locked in tense relationships for centuries. In the past, these disputes were settled on the battlefields. Now however, diplomacy, trade deals, and shifting alliances are the standard method.

**Tawantin:** The oldest unified nation of Abayang, Tawantin is ever expanding, although slowly nowadays. Contrary to the military expansionist Ezcan Empire, Tawantin uses diplomacy, arranged marriage, and treaties to expand their domains. Wars are uncommon, but not unheard of. Their domains extend through most of the western region of the continent, all along the mountain range.



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Known for their solar technology advancements, which are closely linked to their main spirituality tied to the Sun God Inti, the scientist-priests of the empire hold great respect and influence. In Tawantin, science and religion are connected and go hand-in-hand. Many of the temples throughout their territory work as a school or university, and education is accessible to any of its citizens. It is also accessible to most foreign visitors who choose to live and learn with them, so long as they agree to work for the community for six years afterwards. At the end of this period, the student is also offered full citizenship and the option to bring in their family.

**Cambaba:** Located in the northern central part of Abayang, along the Amazon Basin, east of the Tawantin lies Cambaba. Due to its location, Cambaba is protected by wetlands, making the nation's military conquest by others very difficult.

Being the largest supplier of food and agricultural equipment of the continent, thanks to the rich soil and nutrients brought by the river, Cambaba is prosperous and highly populated. They are also proud of their culture and some may consider themselves more cultured than their neighboring nations.

This leads many to make efforts to distinguish themselves from others, making it clear to anyone looking they are from Cambaba.

The nation is also widely known for its textile industry and art; some of its cities are cultural references for the region, attracting people from all over the world.

**Aniil:** Aniil is a small nation in the southern portion of the continent, following the mountain range and with access to the sea through an extensive channel system. Famous for its trading hubs and expert merchants, Aniil is home to the greatest trading companies of the continent.

These merchant organizations are so important in this nation that they can effectively run parts of the cities they operate in, having participation in the nation's government. However, each company is run by their workers, who administer all the aspects of its operations, making sure the people are satisfied, well-supplied, and well-compensated.

People from all over the continent and beyond visit the markets of Aniil, the great city from which the nation took its name, both to make business and to experience the world through their markets.

# MAKASING AND BEYOND

**United Tupi States:** In the central eastern portion of the continent lies a great nation composed of several small states that could very well be their own nations. The United Tupi States formed an alliance to better preserve their territory and people in the face of the threat of the All Tribes War.

The many states all share a common origin in the past, as they all descended from the first Tupi people who migrated all over the continent thousands of years ago. Now, each of them has their own unique customs, traditions, and identity, even though they see each other as brothers and sisters, especially in the backdrop of the much wider world.

This nation is well known for being self-sufficient in many ways, focusing more on internal development and trade than carving a niche for it in international affairs. It took a long and hazardous task to unite all the states into a single united nation, and they intend on making it as strong and unified as they can.

**Confederacy of Bocatá e Hunza:** Located in the northernmost part of the continent, the Confederacy of Bocatá e Hunza is notorious for its mineral resources, booming industry, and technology.

The mineral resources from this nation range from coal, salt, and copper to gold, emeralds, and even lithium, now a very sought-out material, thanks to the technological advancements around the world. This makes the Confederacy a very rich nation, but one which was dependent on extracting its natural resources for its prosperity.

This is why the Confederacy has invested in the development of a rich and large industrial complex, focusing on metallurgy and robotics. Now, the nation is a leading developer of technological advances in those and many other fields, with each of their member states focusing on an area of expertise.





## And Even Further...

We have focused on Cahokia, described the other nations of Makasing, and even outlined the nations in Azayang and Abayang. It's time to set our sights on what lies beyond. With the exception of the Ice Zone and Tanogami, the places listed below are referred to by their real-world names because the people of Makasing haven't given official names to these places yet.

### The Permanent Ice Zone

The white area in the north of Makasing is a brutal mix of permafrost and slow-moving glaciers. The first few years after the Awis were so cold, dark, and violent that it pushed all life southward in a wave. Now that the weather is improving, the glaciers are retreating and the permafrost is thawing somewhat. Many expeditions have been sent north from Makasing into the zone over the last few decades, but few return. Even during the summer, the storms can be sudden and brutal. While much of the wildlife either migrated or became extinct and many people relocated, it is unknown if anyone — or anything — actually calls the zone its permanent home. Some say that there just isn't a way to

support life there, long-term. But others claim to have found signs that point to life in the far north. Either way, until sea or air travel becomes more feasible, making the trek to other continents will need to be done over land and through the zone.

In addition, despite seven centuries having passed, there are many that want to attempt to reclaim their ancestral homelands taken by the permafrost. This is starting to cause some tension in political circles.

### The Tanogami

While not part of the Twelve Nations, the people of the islands east of Azayang and south of Makasing survived the Awis. The turbulent seas cut them off from regular contact with the mainland for centuries, leaving them out of the brutal wars and many of the technological advances made in Makasing and elsewhere. Now that the seas are calming, more reports are coming in every day from the sailors who have visited the islands, or from traders and diplomats arriving in various ports from these places. Their cultural evolution since the Awis is still somewhat of a mystery, but that's likely about to change.

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## Hawai'i

No one in Makasing has any direct proof that anyone from the Hawaiian Islands survived the Awis. Nevertheless, there are persistent legends that some brave souls back in 512 managed to reach the islands and returned with tales of incredible magic being wielded by the population. The sheer ludicrousness of the stories are such that most people in Makasing have dismissed them and it is widely believed that the islands were likely battered in the aftermath of the Awis and that no one survived.

## Africa

A few intrepid ships on the east coast of Abayang are said to have made the trip across the Kangami to the coast of western Africa. No one in Makasing is sure of what they found, or if anyone actually made the journey and returned.

## Asia

No one has been there and returned with any kind of reports. As with Hawai'i, there is wild conjecture that those in the islands of the southwest Sikugami survived, but it is generally dismissed as fantasy.

## Australia

The people of Makasing, Abayang, and Azayang are aware that the continent exists. Beyond that, nothing is known.

## Europe

As with Australia, it is known the continent exists, although it is thought of as part of Asia as they are a single land mass. Recently some explorers have considered following the coasts of Makasing up north and attempting to reach Europe by land hopping, but most are unsure what the point would be, as the Kangami ocean is still fairly unpredictable and there seems to be little reason to make the effort.

